EPISODE 01

1 INT. AVA'S FAMILY DINING ROOM - DAY 1

The dining room is sparsely furnished and worn. CARL JOHNSON (Ava's father) and MARY JOHNSON (Ava's grandmother) sit at the dining table. Next to them is CASH JOHNSON (Ava's older brother), with a small cake in front of him.

Cash closes his eyes to make a wish, while DORA JOHNSON (Ava's mother) looks on with pride. Ava watches Cash and the cake with envy. Dora pats AVA JOHNSON (19) on the shoulder.

DORA
You and Cash are twins. It's your birthday too. Go ahead, make a wish.

Ava sneakily stands behind Cash, and closes her eyes to make a wish.

With his eyes closed, Cash blows out the candles. Mary takes out the candles and slices the cake into four pieces, gives the largest slice, which is the only one with strawberry to * Cash.

MARY
Here you go, Cash! The biggest piece is for you!

Cash takes it eagerly, grinning at Mary.

CASH
Thanks, Grandma! I love cake with strawberries the most!

Mary gives Carl a big slice and gives herself a smaller slice.

Ava carefully reaches for the last piece of cake and Mary sees it and slaps Ava's hand away hard.

MARY
What are you doing? The last piece is saved for your brother! Sneaking food at such a young age? Greedy brat!

Ava clutches her hand, frightened and silent. Dora hears this and rushes forward, shielding Ava.

DORA
Mom! Today is Ava's birthday too. You're favoring Cash—can't Ava even have a bite?

Before she finishes, Mary slaps Dora hard across the face.

MARY
Shut up! You have no say here! Get back to work!

Cash notices some frosting on his clothes and takes off his jacket. Dora grabs Ava and starts to leave when Cash throws the dirty jacket at Ava.

CASH
Ava, wash this for me! I need it for tomorrow!

Dora takes the jacket off Ava and suppresses her anger as she glares at Cash.

DORA
Cash! She's your sister, not the family maid!

Before Cash can respond, Carl slams the table and stands, glaring at Ava. She cowers behind Dora in fear.

CARL
She's worse than a maid!
(glares at Ava)
Lazy and spoiled! The cake is for your brother! You don't deserve it! Now get to work! All you ever do is cry and whine, you little piece of shit!

Carl moves toward Ava in a fury, raises his hand to hit Ava. Dora steps in front of Ava and gets slapped hard by Carl.

Dora's hurt, the corner of her lip bleeding. Ava sobs, throwing herself on Dora's body.

AVA
Mom! Mom, are you okay?

Dora wipes the blood from her mouth, stands up, and moves Ava behind her.

DORA
If you want to pick on someone, come at me! Ava's just a kid!

CARL
You think I won't beat the shit out of you? It's all because of you!
(MORE)

CARL (CONT'D)
You raised Ava to be a selfish, spoiled brat! I'd better teach you a good, hard lesson, you bitch!

Carl picks up a stick from the side, lunging toward mother and daughter with it. Dora protects Ava, who CRIES in fear. Mary's about to step forward and stop them, when Dora suddenly spits out a mouthful of blood. Dora collapses! *

AVA
Mom!

Everyone freezes.

EPISODE 02

2 INT. AVA'S FAMILY BEDROOM - DAY 2

Dora sits weakly on the bed. Ava hands Dora a glass of water. Carl, Cash, and Mary sit on nearby stools.

DORA
I'm fine...

Dora attempts to sit up, but Ava gently pushes her back down.

AVA
Mom! The doctor already told you that you've got a gastric ulcer from overexertion. You need to rest!

MARY
(impatiently)
What a useless creature! What kind of wife collapses from just doing household chores and starts coughing up blood!

CARL
The hospitals are not our personal nursing home. If you're done resting, get back in the kitchen. Those dishes aren't going to wash themselves!

Ava can no longer hold back her anger and responds to Carl.

AVA
Dad! Mom is so sick she can't even get out of bed, and you're still making her work! We need to take her to the hospital!

Carl, enraged, strides over and slaps Ava. She cries out, clutching her face. Dora rushes to hold Ava's hand, her heart aching.

DORA
Don't hit her!

CARL
Where would we get the money to treat your mother? You know our situation well enough! Starting tomorrow, you'll stay home to take care of your mother!

AVA
Dad! I just got an offer from a big company! I need this job! Why should I stay home while Cash does nothing? He's also her son!

CARL
(enraged)
You owe this family! You won't get a single penny for your travel! Let's see how you leave! You're staying to care for your mother and the house and that's final!

Ava, her face stinging, glares at Carl. Cash, feigning innocence, steps forward, playing the dutiful son.

CASH
Dad! Grandma! I'll stay and take care of Mom. If Ava insists on working, let her go. I can handle things here.

CARL
No! I worked hard to secure you a job. Focus on it and do it well!
(to Ava)
As for you, you were the reason for your stillborn brother, leaving your mother unable to have more children. Now you must make amends. You owe this family for life!

Cash lowers his head, smirking slyly. Dora looks at Carl, horrified.

DORA
Carl, the stillbirth was my own fall;

(MORE)

DORA (CONT'D)
it had nothing to do with Ava. Ava's our daughter, don’t treat her this way.

CARL
She’s a devil! It must be her curse that led to her stillborn brother's death. I was merciful not to send her to an orphanage!

Ava, furious and heartbroken, finally explodes.

AVA
Dad! How can you say that about me? And why won’t you let Mom get treated? Why do I have to give up my job? Cash’s job is far less sought-after than mine!

Tears stream down Ava’s face as she cries uncontrollably.

CASH
Ava, stop shouting! Mom is still sick! You’re a girl—just listen to Dad. He knows what’s best for you!

DORA
No, Ava needs to work too. I just need some rest, then I’ll be fine...

Before Dora can finish, she starts coughing. Mary steps forward, glaring at Dora.

MARY
Oh Dora, shut up! Look at yourself, you're in no shape to cook and clean for us? Cash's career has only just started! Ava will stay put and take care of us, and hopefully land herself a rich husband!

Ava, trembling with anger, wipes her tears away.

AVA
Fine! I’ll earn the travel expenses myself! No treatment for Mom? I’ll save up and pay for that myself, too! You and Cash can be the family you want. Even if I have to borrow money, I’ll leave this place!

Carl sneers and shoves a stack of cash into Cash’s hands.

CARL
Cash, here's your allowance. Don't skimp on yourself now that you've started working.

CASH
(excited) *
Dad, this is a big money!

CARL
Spend it on networking. You'll need it. I'll give you more each month!

Mary adds cash from her purse, handing it to Cash.

MARY
Here, take this too!

Cash pockets the money with a wide grin.

CASH
Thanks, Dad. Thanks, Grandma!

Ava, watching the trio revel in harmony, tries to speak but is stopped by Dora, who grabs her arm and shakes her head.

DORA
Don't say anything more. If you anger your father, he'll lock you up like me, and you'll never escape.

As the three leave, Dora coughs blood. Seeing this, Ava bursts into tears.

AVA
Mom! I promise I'll find a way to get you treated!

EPISODE 03

3 EXT. OUTSIDE OF TOM'S HOUSE - DAY 3

Ava hesitates at the door, unsure whether to knock.

AVA (V.O.)
Uncle Tom has always been kind to me, encouraging me to study. He'll probably lend me the money, right?

Ava gathers her courage and is about to knock when the door suddenly opens. TOM (middle-age, unmarried neighbor) sees Ava standing there and is momentarily surprised.

TOM
Ava? What brings you here?
(noticing her hesitation)
Come in if you need something!

4 INT. TOM'S HOUSE LIVING ROOM - DAY 4

Ava exhales in relief and steps into Tom's house. Tom locks the door behind them, a sly grin appearing on his face.

Ava sits on the sofa while Tom takes a seat next to her.

AVA
Uncle Tom, you know my mom is sick. I've also received an job offer from a big company, but my dad won't let me leave or give me travel expenses. Could you please lend me some money?

Ava nervously clasps her hands together, unaware that Tom is eyeing her up and down.

TOM
Don't worry. How much do you need?

AVA
Can I borrow $1,000...

She turns to face Tom, only to find his face uncomfortably close, startling her. She recoils, putting distance between them. Tom pulls out a check, fills in it and stuffs it into Ava's pocket, gripping her hand excitedly.

TOM
Here's $10,000. Ava.

AVA
Thank you so much, uncle Tom.

TOM
This little sum of money is nothing. If you marry me, I'll give you everything...

Tom grows more agitated and reaches out to hug Ava.

AVA
(crying)
Uncle Tom! What are you doing? Stop! Stop!

Unable to break free, Ava grabs a mug from the table and smashes it against Tom's head. Tom collapses, dazed. Ava pushes him away forcefully.

AVA (cont'd)
You're disgusting! If it wasn't for my mother's sickness, I would never borrow money from you. I'll pay you back double in the future.

Tom crawls toward Ava, trying to grab her leg. Ava screams and runs out.

5 INT. AVA'S FAMILY BEDROOM - DAY 5

Ava wipes her tears and sits beside her mother, who lies in bed. Dora notices Ava's pale expression and looks at her with concern.

DORA
What happened? Did your father hit you again? Where does it hurt? Let me see!

Ava shakes her head, forcing a smile as she hands Dora the check.

AVA
Mom, this is the money Uncle Tom lent me. With this, you can finally get treatment!

DORA
What about you? Your travel expenses? When will you leave? Don't miss your start date!

AVA
This money is just enough for your treatment. (shaking her head) Dad was right—I should stay to take care of you.
(choking up)
Maybe this is my fate. I'll accept it! I can't lose you, Mom!

Tears stream down Ava's face, she quickly wipes them away. Dora's expression hardens.

DORA
What did you say? Say it again.

AVA
I'll stay and take care of you—

Before Ava can finish, Dora slaps her hard.

DORA
Listen to me carefully! If you give up your job and your future for me, I'll die right here and now! Do you think I've worked so hard for you to stay trapped here, in fear and poverty? I want you to have a better life! How can you...

Dora, trembling with anger, starts coughing uncontrollably and sees blood on her hand. Ava panics.

AVA
Mom! Don't get upset! I'll work—I'll work hard! I'll leave here, I promise!

Both mother and daughter cry, overcome with emotion. Suddenly, the bedroom door bursts open. Carl storms in and kicks Ava to the ground.

CARL
Leave? Over my dead body! You're never leaving this house!

EPISODE 04

6 INT. AVA'S FAMILY BEDROOM - DAY - CONTINUOUS

Carl storms forward and snatches the check from Dora's hands. Ava, crying, picks herself up from the ground, glaring at Carl with hatred. Carl, seeing Ava's defiance, grows even angrier.

CARL
You're not going anywhere! Tom already came and said he wants to marry you. It's settled—you'll prepare to marry Tom!

AVA
NO! You don't deserve to be my father! You should have just strangled me when I was born, paying for the life of your unborn son!

Carl, enraged, steps forward and grabs Ava by the neck. Ava struggles to breathe and writhes in pain.

CARL
Fine! Then I'll grant you that today!

Dora anxiously gets up from the bed and rushes to push Carl away. Ava holds her neck, gasping for air.

DORA
Carl, are you out of your mind?! Ava is still a child! She's your daughter!

AVA
I'm not his daughter! I wish I had never been born into this family!

Dora looks panicked, and Carl, in fury, grabs a bat near the door and strikes Ava across the legs. Ava screams in pain and collapses to the floor.

CARL
I'll kill you today! Let's see how you run away now!

Carl raises the bat again, ready to strike. Dora, heartbroken, throws herself over Ava, shielding her.

DORA
Carl! Please stop! Ava is still a kid! Forgive her, I beg you!

Carl ignores her plea and strikes Ava again. Ava CRIES OUT in agony, unable to speak through her SOBS. Dora clings to her, sobbing helplessly.

CARL
Move out of the way! Or I'll beat you too!

DORA
Go ahead, just kill me then! But I won't let you hit Ava!

Carl shoves Dora aside violently. She falls to the ground with a painful GROAN. Carl points the bat at Ava.

CARL
Say it! Say you dare to run away from me—and from this family!

Ava struggles to her feet, trembling but defiant as she fights through her leg pain. She looks Carl straight in the eye.

AVA
I'm leaving this place! From now on, I have nothing to do with any of you. I'll walk my own path!

Ava storms out angrily, but suddenly, Mary appears at the bedroom door, grabbing Ava's hair. Ava screams in pain.

MARY
You little bitch! You're not going anywhere!

EPISODE 05

7 INT. AT THE DOOR OF AVA'S BEDROOM - DAY

Mary grabs Ava by the hair, dragging her into Dora's bedroom, while Carl pulls Dora out.

DORA
Mom! Stop it!

Mary shoves Ava into the room and quickly locks the door behind her.

MARY
You little bitch! You're not going anywhere! Stay here at home!

8 INT. AVA'S BEDROOM - DAY 8

Ava beats on the door and sobs.

AVA
Grandma! Open the door! Let me out!

MARY (V.O.)
You can only come out if you agree to marry Tom.

CARL (V.O.)
And take care of your mother! And take care of the family! Or you're not going anywhere!

Ava, crying and banging on the door, shouts desperately.

AVA
I won’t marry him! Open the door! Open it!

9 INT. AT THE DOOR OF AVA'S BEDROOM - DAY

MARY
It’s not up to you! The money Tom is offering for the marriage is more than you could earn in decades! You must marry him!

Ava cries harder, shouting for Dora, rubbing her painful legs.

AVA (V.O.)
Mom! Please, help me! Find a way to get me out of here!

Dora stands at the door, tears streaming down her face as she pleads.

DORA
Mom, Ava’s only 19.

CARL
Getting married early is the best choice for her! Being a housewife is much easier than struggling with a job. Why work when Tom can provide for her — and for our family? This is for everyone's good!

MARY
Ava’s marriage is decided! Dora, keep your mouth shut!

CARL
Dora, I’m warning you—if you let Ava out, I’ll break your legs too!

Dora trembles in fear, tears falling silently as she clenches her fists. Cash walks over and puts an arm around Dora’s shoulders.

CASH
Mom, Tom is a rich man. Ava will live a far better life than working tirelessly to make pennies. You should be happy for her.

Carl steps beside Cash.

CARL
That’s my boy! Cash, here’s some extra money from Dad. Take your girlfriend out and have fun!

CASH
Thanks, Dad!

10 INT. AVA'S BEDROOM - DAY 10

Inside the bedroom, Ava hears everything and collapses to the floor in tears.

11 INT. AT THE DOOR OF AVA'S BEDROOM - DAY

Dora stands in a corner, her eyes filled with tears of rage as she glares at Carl, Mary, and Cash, her fists trembling.

12 EXT. SIDE OF THE ROAD - NIGHT 12

Dora pulls Ava along, running as fast as they can. Ava carries a worn-out bag, both of them panting heavily. Dora glances back to ensure no one is following. A taxi is parked nearby, and they stop beside it.

Dora takes a few bills out of her pocket and presses them into Ava’s hand.

DORA
Ava, I saved 200 dollars. Take them and just go! If they catch up to us, it’ll be too late!

AVA
Mom! I can’t! You're saving up for your meds! I can't leave! What will you do if I’m gone?

DORA
I’ll be fine! Just go!
(pushing Ava)
If you don’t, your father will catch you, and then you’ll never escape!

AVA
But—

Suddenly, Carl’s voice echoes from the street behind them.

CARL
Stop! Get your ass back here now!

Dora and Ava turn to see Carl and Mary running toward them. Dora pushes Ava into the taxi.

DORA
Go, now!

Dora slams the taxi door shut, and the taxi starts moving. Ava leans out the window, crying as she looks back. She sees Dora standing in the street, blocking Carl and Mary. Mary shoves Dora to the ground.

13 INT. TAXI - NIGHT 13

AVA
Mom!

14 EXT. SIDE OF THE ROAD - NIGHT 14

Dora watches as the taxi fades into the darkness, and finally gives in, only to be kicked and punched by Carl and Mary. Through her pain, she lifts her head and shouts...

DORA
Go! Don’t look back!

15 INT. TAXI - NIGHT 15

Ava sobs uncontrollably, her fists clenched tightly.

AVA (V.O.)
Mom! I swear I’ll make something of myself! I’ll come back for you! Just wait for me!

EPISODE 06

MONTAGE:

16 INT. RESTAURANT - DAY 16 *

Ava is mopping the restaurant floor. *

17 INT.CONFERENCE ROOM- DAY 17 *

Eric hands Ava the contract, and they smile as they shake hands. *

18 INT. OFFICE - NIGHT 18

In the company office, Ava focused on her work at the computer, while the sky outside gradually shifted from night to day.

MATCH CUT TO:

Super TITLE: "Eight Years Later"

19 INT. COMPANY MEETING ROOM - DAY 19

Ava, now a polished businesswoman, stands by the window, gazing outside. The door opens, and her assistant GARY stands in the doorway, knocking.

GARY
(smiling)
Miss CEO, everyone is waiting for you.

Ava turns around and smiles.

20 EXT. FRONT YARD OF AVA'S FAMILY HOUSE - DAY

Mary walks toward her house. NEIGHBOR A and NEIGHBOR B stand nearby, both noticing Mary, then begin gossiping after she passes by. Mary slows her pace and tilts her head, quietly listening.

NEIGHBOR A
Have you heard about their daughter, Ava? She's working at strip clubs and sleeping with who knows how many men!

NEIGHBOR B
What a disgrace! How could someone like that come from our town?

Dora returns home, carrying shopping bags and walking towards Mary. Neighbor A sees and hurriedly pulls Neighbor B away.

NEIGHBOR A
Shh! Don't let Dora hear us.

Dora looks puzzled as she reaches Mary. Mary instantly slaps Dora across the face.

DORA
(hand on her cheek)
Mom! What was that for?

MARY
If you hadn't let Ava go, she wouldn't be out there embarrassing us! Do you know what they're saying? To everyone, we're a big fucking joke! It's all your fault!

DORA
They're wrong. Ava is a good girl! I know she'd never do such a thing!

MARY
Then why's everyone calling her a slut, saying she's selling herself all over town? She better not show her face here—if she does, I'll break her legs!

EPISODE 07

21 INT. COMPANY MEETING ROOM - DAY 21

Ava is leading a meeting with several employees (muted).

NARRATOR (V.O.)
Since joining Young Group, Ava has increased the company's profits tenfold within eight short years, solidifying herself as a powerhouse in the business world.

22 INT. COMPANY MEETING ROOM - DAY 22

Ava sits at the window, scrolling through her phone.

AVA (V.O.)
Eight years… Mom, how have you been? In three months, my confidentiality agreement with Eric's company will end. I can finally go back and bring you home with me!

Eric, dressed in a suit and pulling a suitcase and notices Ava standing there. He approaches, stands beside her and holds her arm.

ERIC
Thinking about your mom again? You identity will be revealed, and you billion-dollar assets will be unfrozen. You can go home now!

Ava hugs Eric tightly.

AVA
Honey, please tell project manager Mike to ensure the factory is completed quickly. After that, we must build malls, schools, and public facilities in the town to improve everyone’s lives!

ERIC
Already taken care of! By the way, your brother’s wedding is soon. Are you going back to attend it?

AVA
What? Cash is getting married? Mom’s life will only get harder! She’s still unwell. No, I have to bring her out of there immediately! Have Gary prepare the car—I need to leave now!

Eric grabs Ava's arm.

ERIC
Wait, sweetheart. Give me two days. Let me return from the business trip to France, and I’ll go home with you.

AVA
No, I can’t wait, Eric. I need to get my mom now! You can meet me there after your trip.

Ava rushes out, and Eric, concerned, pulls out his phone to make a call.

ERIC
Gary, terminate Ava's confidentiality agreement immediately. Time to let the world know her real identity-a billionaire with power and influence.

GARY (O.S.)
Won’t the shareholders be upset?

ERIC
I’ll handle them. Let Ava go home with peace of mind!

23 EXT. CONSTRUCTION SITE IN AVA'S HOMETOWN - DAY

MIKE stands on the roadside, speaking into his phone with a respectful tone.

MIKE
Yes, yes, understood! Oh my gosh! The Boss is coming! I'll make sure everything is perfect!

Mike hangs up and walks toward the workers with a proud demeanor.

MIKE (cont'd)
Everyone listen up! Work hard and proper. If the Boss isn't satisfied, none of you will see a paycheck! Got it?

EPISODE 08

24 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY 24

The hall is decorated with round tables covered with food and drinks. GUESTS gather in groups, chatting and enjoying. Tony, the town mayor, steps to the center, doing a toast.

TONY
Today's the wedding of Carl' son Cash! Let's wish Cash a wonderful marriage!

TONY, the Mayor, turns to face Carl and Cash, raising his glass. The NEIGHBORS join in, lifting their glasses.

NEIGHBORS
Congratulations, Cash!

CASH
Thank you, everyone! Enjoy yourselves!

The Neighbors drink from their glasses. Dora stands beside Mary, forcing a strained smile as she sips her drink.

CARL
On this joyous occasion, I have an important announcement to make! My daughter Ava ran away from home years ago. Recently, I've learned that she's brought shame to the family with her lewd behavior.
(MORE)

CARL (CONT'D)
I suggest to remove her name from the factory's bonus share allocation! I shall have no daughter of such disgrace!

MARY
That's right! My grandson Cash worked hard to secure a position at the Young Group through his fiancée's connections. We cannot let Ava tarnish his future!

Dora freezes, shocked.

DORA
No! Carl! You can't do this! The town is building a factory, and everyone is entitled to a share. That share rightfully belongs to Ava!

TONY
Ava has shamed herself and doesn't deserve the town's money! Carl is right — she's a stain on our reputation! Today, in front of everyone, I officially declare Ava banished from our town!

Dora, terrified, rushes forward and falls to her knees before Tony.

DORA
Please, Mayor Tony, don't expel Ava! She grew up here, she's part of our town. She deserves her share like everyone else!

She pleads while banging her head against the ground, but Tony remains unmoved.

TONY
Dora, don't you see? Ava abandoned this town long ago. She's the one who trampled on our name! Now she's coming back for the money! Over my dead body!

NEIGHBORS
Get rid of her! Never let her come back!

Dora, still kneeling, turns to face the neighbors.

DORA
This is my fault! Ava is my daughter — I'll take responsibility! Punish me instead, but please don't deny Ava the money she's entitled to!

TONY
Dora, it's not about being cruel—it's about Ava's mistakes. Your pleas won't change anything. Please, get up.

Dora refuses to move, determined to stay on her knees.

DORA
No, I won't get up until Ava is forgiven and given what she deserves!

MARY
How embarrassing! Carl must have been blind to marry you. You've disgraced our family!

Mary strides over and slaps Dora hard across the face.

EPISODE 09

25 I/E. INSIDE CAR / ROAD OUTSIDE THE TOWN - DAY

Gary drives while reporting to Ava.

GARY
Boss, we're almost at your hometown. The town is just ahead!

AVA
Good! Hurry up! *

26 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY 26

Dora holds her cheek, remaining silent. A neighbor standing beside Tony hands him a registry book. Tony takes out a pen, preparing to cross out Ava's name. Dora rushes forward to stop him.

DORA
You can't do this! Don't erase Ava's name! Ava is my child! I know she wouldn't do those things!

MARY
Stop being so stubborn, Dora! Ava isn't coming back! What's the point of stopping us? Without her, Cash gets a little more of the shares and more money later! What's wrong with that?

DORA
That money belongs to Ava! Cash can't have it! Ava will come back—she just can't return right now!

CASH
Mom! Wake up! Ava isn't coming back! If she were, she would've contacted you at least once all these years! She's too ashamed to show her face, living as some sleazy guy's whore!

Dora shoves Cash aside.

DORA
She's your sister! You're twins! How can you say such things about her?

CASH
I don't have a shameless sister like her!

MARY
If you hadn't let her go back then, we wouldn't be a laughingstock in this town! We can't even hold our heads high!

Tony steps up to Dora, glaring down at her.

TONY
As a mother, you failed to raise Ava properly! Instead of reflecting on your failures, you're only thinking about the money? A greedy woman like you deserves punishment!
(raises his cane)
Do you accept it?

Dora lowers her head.

DORA
Just don't drive Ava away. Don't take her money. I'll accept whatever punishment you give me.

Dora turns her back to Tony. Tony lifts his cane and strikes her hard.

TONY
The first strike—for failing to educate your child properly!

Dora screams in pain. Tony strikes her a second time.

TONY (cont'd)
The second strike—for disrespecting your elders and being greedy!

Dora cries out again, blood seeping through her shirt. Carl and Mary turn away, indifferent. Tony delivers a third blow, harder than the last.

TONY (cont'd)
The third strike—for Ava's disgraceful actions, shaming this town by becoming a whore!

Dora collapses to the ground, coughing up blood. She struggles to stand but cannot.

27 EXT. OUTSIDE OF WEDDING HALL - DAY 27

A car pulls up at the gate outside the Engagement Party Hall.

Gary steps out and opens the door for Ava.

GARY
Boss, we've arrived.

Ava steps out and approaches the gate. As Gary moves to follow her, Ava holds up a hand to stop him.

AVA
I'll handle this myself. You go make arrangements for the gifts I brought for Cash. After that, pick up Eric.

Gary bows respectfully.

GARY
Understood, Boss.

Ava straightens her posture and strides toward the house, exuding confidence and authority.

28 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY 28

As Ava enters the Hall, she freezes, seeing Dora collapsed on the ground, coughing up blood and barely conscious. Ava's eyes widen in shock, and she shouts.

AVA
Mom!

Dora weakly lifts her head, her vision blurry. Tears of relief stream down her face as she sees Ava. With great effort, she stretches out her hand.

DORA
Ava…

Everyone in the Hall turns to look at Ava, their faces frozen in disbelief.

----------Paywall----------

EPISODE 10

29 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 29

Everyone stares at Ava in shock as she rushes to Dora. She kneels and helps Dora sit up.

AVA
Mom, it's me! Ava! I'm back!

Dora looks at Ava in disbelief, reaching out to touch her face.

DORA
Ava… Am I dreaming?

Ava, crying, holds her mother's hand tightly.

AVA
Mom! It's me! I'm so sorry for being away so long!

The two embrace, sobbing uncontrollably. The neighbors, watching from the sidelines, mutter with disdain.

NEIGHBOR A
I can't believe Ava has the nerve to come back!

NEIGHBOR B
Tony should kick her out immediately! This town doesn't need someone like her!

Ava notices the blood on the corner of Dora's mouth and panics.

AVA
Mom, what happened?

Dora, with Ava's help, stands shakily, forcing a smile.

DORA
It's nothing, just a small injury.

As she speaks, Dora sways, almost collapsing. Ava catches her.

AVA
Mom? Mom! Are you okay?

DORA
I'm fine… Seeing you safe is all that matters to me.

Ava looks around at the crowd, her eyes full of fury.

AVA
Mom, don't worry! I'm taking you away from here! From now on, no one will ever hurt you again!

Carl storms forward, slapping Ava across the face.

CARL
How dare you come back! Look at yourself! You should've died out there!

Ava, holding her cheek, stares at Carl, her voice trembling with both pain and anger.

AVA
Dad, I just got back. You didn't even ask me anything—you just hit me. What do you think I've done?

CASH
What you've done? Don't play dumb! Everyone in this town knows about you!

AVA
Knows what? Never mind—I'm here today for Cash's Wedding.

CASH
Shut up! Someone like you has no right to attend my party! Get out!

Mary approaches, pointing her cane at Ava.

MARY
Cash is right! You're a filthy woman! You shouldn't even be standing here! Carl, throw her out! She's tainting our family!

Carl grabs Mary's cane, his face twisted with anger. He points it at Ava as he approaches her.

CARL
You ran away just to become a stripper? If I'd known you'd bring this shame on us, I would've beaten you to death back then!

Carl raises the cane, ready to strike. Dora throws herself in front of Ava, her arms outstretched.

DORA
Carl, stop! Ava just got back. Let her explain herself!

MARY
Explain? What is there to explain? She has the audacity to show her face here! I don't even want to hear it!

DORA
No! Ava would never do those things! Ava, tell them what you've been doing all these years!

Carl tries to push Dora aside.

CARL
Move! This is your fault, Dora! You didn't raise Ava properly! That's why she turned out like this! Don't try to stop me today!

Dora stares at Carl, unwavering.

DORA
I won’t move! Today, I won’t let you hurt Ava again! You’re her father—why don’t you believe her?

CARL
Fine, then I’ll beat you both!

Cash steps forward, smirking.

CASH
Mom, stop protecting her. Why don’t you ask her yourself? She’s probably back here because she has an extra mouth to feed! A bastard with no father!

AVA
What did you say? A bastard?

CASH
Stop pretending. You have no shame for all the whoring you're known for. Who knows how many men you've screwed?!

AVA (V.O.)
So the rumor comes because of my eight-year confidentiality agreement. I should’ve come back sooner.

Dora grabs Ava’s hand, looking at her anxiously.

DORA
Ava, tell them the truth! I know you would never do those things!

Ava holds her mother’s hand firmly.

AVA
Mom, I swear to God in heaven, I’ve never done anything like that. I would rather die than do such a thing! Dad, Grandma, you’ve all fallen to gossip!

DORA
I believe Ava wouldn’t do that!

Mary slams her cane on the ground in frustration.

MARY
You think we’re as gullible as your mother?

(MORE)

MARY (CONT'D)
You claim you weren't selling your body, then explain why you've been gone for eight years without a single word or visit!

Ava looks at Carl and Mary with a calm, determined expression.

AVA
Dad, Grandma, I am now the CEO of a corporation. Because of a confidentiality agreement, I couldn't return or contact anyone.

EPISODE 11

30 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 30

Neighbors gather in small groups, whispering among themselves.

NEIGHBOR A
She's a CEO? Really?

NEIGHBOR B
No way. We know what she's like. She's just average—how could she possibly be a CEO?

Dora looks at Ava, her face full of hope.

DORA
Ava, is it true?

AVA
It's true, Mom. I'm doing really well now! Come with me, and I'll show you my company.

DORA
That's wonderful! Knowing you've made it, I can finally stop worrying.

Cash scoffs loudly.

CASH
Ava, stop lying. You? A CEO? You might as well say you're some guy's sugar baby—we'd believe that more easily!

Mary pats Cash on the shoulder approvingly.

MARY
Exactly! My Cash is so talented, and even he only managed to find a job after years of hard work. You're saying you're a CEO? What, you think you're better than my Cash?

AVA
You don't believe me?

MARY
Oh, I believe you… I believe you're a stripper! Given your looks, it must've been tough, though. Look at your jewelry—it's too expensive for you to afford. Did a "client" give it to you?

AVA
Grandma, these were gifts from my husband.

MARY
Husband? More like a sugar daddy? Who knows how you got them from him!

CASH
Grandma, our family doesn't need this dirty stuff. We should sell it—it'd be more useful for my wedding expenses.

MARY
You're right! Cash is getting married soon and needs money.

Mary lunges forward and grabs at Ava's bracelet.

AVA
What are you doing? Let go!

Dora rushes to intervene as the group struggles.

DORA
Mom, how can you take things from your granddaughter?

Mary slaps Dora hard, making her stagger backward.

MARY
This has nothing to do with you! Stay out of it! Ava, give it to me!

Mary snatches the bracelet from Ava, her eyes glinting with greed.

MARY (cont'd)
It’s mine now! I’ll sell it and use the money for Cash’s wedding.

AVA
Give it back! After all these years, you’re still this biased toward Cash!

Mary smirks, patting Cash’s shoulder with pride.

MARY
You’re just jealous that Cash is better than you.

CASH
Watch your tone, Ava. Grandma worked hard to raise you. What’s wrong with her taking something from you? You should’ve given it to her willingly.

AVA
So if I don’t give it, you just take it? That’s mine! Give it back!

Ava lunges forward to grab her bracelet, but Carl slaps her hard across the face, silencing her.

CARL
Enough! How long are you going to keep causing trouble?

EPISODE 12

31 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 31

Ava holds her face, looking at the family members in front of her with tears of anger and disappointment.

AVA
Eight years. I thought you might have changed. But no—you’re just as selfish, barbaric, and unreasonable as before! Cash is still the only one you care about!

Carl, enraged, points a trembling finger at Ava.

CARL
You’re not worthy to be compared to Cash!

(MORE)

CARL (CONT'D)
He’s better than you in every way! You were the one who said you’d leave this house and have nothing to do with us!

AVA
Yes, I did! And I shouldn’t have expected you to change. We have nothing to do with each other anymore. Today, I’m taking my mom with me!

CARL
What did you say? Take her? You dare?

AVA
Why wouldn’t I? You do nothing but hit and scold her. From now on, I’m taking her away! We’ll never come back!

Carl is speechless with rage, and Cash quickly rushes to steady him.

CASH
Dad, please don’t get so upset. It’s not good for your health.

Cash turns to Ava, his expression venomous.

CASH (cont'd)
Ava, you’re the one who should burn in hell! Look at what you’ve done to Dad!

AVA
Dad himself said it—we have no relationship anymore! And you? You’re not even fit to be called my brother!

Ava grabs Dora’s hand and starts walking away.

AVA (cont'd)
Mom, let’s go!

MARY
Stop right there! You’re not going anywhere!

Ava stops and turns back to face Mary.

MARY (cont'd)
You can leave, but Dora is Carl' wife! And Cash's mother! She belongs here!

AVA
I'm taking her with me anyway!

CASH
That's not how things work in this town! If you take her, you'll tear this family apart! God will punish you for doing something so wicked!

Suddenly, a loud clap of THUNDER echoes through the sky. Carl, Mary, and Cash flinch in fear, their faces pale.

AVA
See that? If anyone's being punished by God, it's people like you!

TONY
It's over! It's over! God is angry! Our town is doomed to suffer!

NEIGHBOR A
It's because of her! She's done terrible things out there and brought God's wrath here!

NEIGHBOR B
She's going to get us all killed! What do we do?

Mary, both frightened and furious, yells at Ava, though her voice is trembling.

MARY
Shut up and leave! Just go! Don't drag our town down with you!

AVA
I've done nothing wrong, so I have nothing to fear!

TONY
You still dare to talk back? You need to be punished, to repent for your sins! Only then can our town be saved!

TWO NEIGHBORS step forward and grab Ava by the arms. Ava struggles but can't break free.

AVA
What are you doing? Let me go!

EPISODE 13

32 I/E. MOUNTAIN ROAD / INSIDE CAR - DAY 32

Several cars make their way along a winding mountain road. Eric sits in the back seat, his face filled with anxiety as he looks out at the road ahead.

ERIC
Faster! Drive faster! If we're too late, Ava could be in danger!

GRAY
Boss, the road is too narrow. We can't go any faster.

Eric grabs his phone and tries to call.

PHONE VOICE (V.O.)
The number you are trying to reach is not in service.

Eric slams the phone down in frustration.

ERIC
Damn it!

33 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 33

Ava struggles against the neighbors holding her. Dora rushes forward to pull Ava away but can't overpower them.

AVA
Let me go! Let me go!

Neighbor A leans in close to Tony, pointing at Dora.

NEIGHBOR A
Tony, she's just as guilty as Ava!

TONY
You're right! Restrain her too!

The Neighbors pull Dora away from Ava. Ava screams desperately.

AVA
Let go of my mom! Let her go!
(turning to Mary)
Dad, Grandma! Please, help my mom!

CARL
Ava! Even now, you refuse to repent! Your mother is suffering because of you!

Tony raises his cane high above his head.

TONY
Oh Lord, we repent before You! Punish the true sinner and spare us Your wrath!

He brings the cane down on Dora's back, striking her repeatedly. Dora screams in agony as Ava cries and begs.

AVA
Don't hurt my mom! I'm begging you! Mom!

After several strikes, the neighbors release Dora. She collapses to the ground, her back covered in bloody welts. Ava is released and rushes to kneel beside Dora, sobbing.

AVA (cont'd)
Mom, I'll take you to the hospital!

She struggles to lift Dora, who can barely stand. Just as they begin to move, Mary steps in front of them, blocking their path.

MARY
No one is going anywhere!

EPISODE 14

34 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 34

Ava, in tears, pleads with Mary.

AVA
Please, let me take my mom to the hospital. She's seriously injured…

MARY
The atonement ritual isn't finished! No one is leaving! Do you want to bring ruin upon all of us?

Ava stands, her eyes blazing with anger as she stares at her grandmother.

AVA
What's more important—my mom's life or your so-called atonement ritual?

MARY
Of course, the safety of the entire town is more important! If we're truly punished, will you take responsibility?

AVA
Atonement? Stop using that as an excuse! You only care about yourselves. You don't care if my mom lives or dies!

CASH
She's in this situation because of you! Ava, you should've died out there!

AVA
Cash! Mom has always treated you so well. Are you really going to stand here and watch her die? Are you even human?

CARL
Watch your mouth! He's your brother! I should've beaten you to death earlier!

AVA
I don't need a brother as heartless as him!

Carl steps forward, ready to hit Ava again. Suddenly, Cash's phone RINGS. He holds up a hand to quiet everyone and answers with a big smile.

CASH
Hello? Babe… What? You're coming over now? But I—

The call ends abruptly. Cash looks panicked as he turns to Carl and Mary.

CASH (cont'd)
Dad, Grandma, Anna's on her way here! If she finds out my sister's a whore, she might call off the wedding!

Mary glares at Ava and points a trembling finger at her.

MARY
Ava, get out! Get as far away as possible! If you ruin Cash and Anna's Wedding, I swear I'll make you pay!

Mary lunges forward to grab Ava, but Ava shoves her hand away. Mary stumbles back into Cash's arms.

AVA
A moment ago, you wouldn't let me leave. Now you're desperate to get rid of me? I'll leave, but only if my mom comes with me!

MARY
Over my dead body! Your mom isn't going anywhere!

AVA
Then I'm staying too. Let's see who outlasts who!

CASH
Fine! I'm begging you—just leave, okay?

ANNA (O.S.)
Cash!

Anna storms into the yard, her face furious. Cash rushes toward her, but she pushes his hand away angrily.

ANNA (cont'd)
Cash, what's the meaning of this? I've been calling you forever! Why didn't you come out to greet me?

CASH
Anna, I was just… busy. I swear, it won't happen again.

Dora grips Ava's hand tightly, mumbling under her breath.

DORA
It's over… it's all over…

AVA
Mom, what's wrong?

DORA
Anna's here to demand money! She told your brother she needs a large sum before agreeing to marry him. I'm afraid they'll force you to give it to them…

AVA
Don't worry, Mom. No one can force us.

Anna notices Ava and narrows her eyes.

ANNA
Who is she?

CASH
She's… a distant relative. We don't keep in touch often…

Cash steps closer to Ava and whispers fiercely.

CASH (cont'd)
Ava, I'm warning you—don't mention we're siblings! If Anna leaves me because of you, I'll make your life hell!

Ava steps forward confidently and smiles at Anna.

AVA
Hi, Anna. I'm Ava, Cash's twin sister.

Anna's face twists in shock and disgust.

ANNA
Oh, so you're Ava? The home-wrecking hooker?

EPISODE 15

35 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 35

Ava freezes, stepping forward to explain.

AVA
I'm not—

Anna raises a hand in panic, stopping Ava.

ANNA
Don't come near me! Stay right there!

Cash tries to calm Anna, but she furiously hits him with her bag.

ANNA (cont'd)
Cash, what’s the meaning of this? A filthy woman like her shouldn’t even be here! Why didn’t you throw her out earlier? Don't you want to get married? Fine, I’m leaving!

Cash grabs Anna’s arm, panicking, and looks to Mary for help.

CASH
Grandma…

MARY
Anna, don’t be upset! I’ll make her leave right now!

CASH
Yes, yes! Babe, I promise this will never happen again!

MARY
Ava! Get out of here now!

AVA
Why should I leave? If anyone should go, it’s her!

MARY
Don’t be ridiculous! She’s Cash’s fiancée—we’re family! You’re not part of this family anymore, so you have to leave!

ANNA
Who knows how many men you’ve slept with? Ew! Just looking at you makes me sick. Stay away from me!

AVA
This is our first meet, and I’ve been respectful. You’d better show me the same respect.

Anna sneers dismissively.

ANNA
Respect? People like you don’t deserve respect. If you’re bold enough to act like that, don’t cry when people call you out!

AVA
One more word, and I won’t hold back.

ANNA
Oh, really? What are you going to do? Hit me? Trash like you should be locked up!

Anna turns to Cash, who flinches nervously.

ANNA (cont'd)
Hey, where’s the 50 thousand dollars I asked you to prepare? Did you get it or not?

Cash stammers, looking helplessly at Carl.

CASH
Dad…

Anna shifts her gaze to Carl and Mary, whose expressions turn awkward. Anna’s face darkens as she glares back at Cash.

ANNA
You’ve had all this time, and you still haven’t gotten it? I see—you don’t want to get married. Fine! I’m calling it off!

Anna starts to storm off, but Cash pulls her back, putting on a desperate, ingratiating smile.

CASH
Anna, we’re ready.

Cash glances at Mary, then nods toward the bracelet in her hands. Anna’s eyes light up.

CASH (cont'd)
This diamond bracelet is worth more than 50 thousand! I’ll sell it, and then we can get married.

Anna smiles in satisfaction, while Mary clutches the diamond bracelet tightly.

MARY
Yes, it’s all for you two!

Dora suddenly rushes forward, trying to grab the jewelry.

DORA
No! This isn’t Cash’s—it’s Ava’s!

Mary shoves Dora aside, but Dora lunges again, trying to take it back. Mary raises her hand to strike Dora, but Ava grabs her arm firmly.

AVA
Don’t you dare hit my mother!

EPISODE 16

36 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 36

Cash glares at Ava with rage.

CASH
You filthy wretch! What are you doing? Get lost!

AVA
I’m staying right here. No one is going to bully my mom while I’m here!

CASH
Ava, have you lost your mind? If you keep this up, don’t blame me for what happens next!

AVA
Go ahead, try me! I’ll call the police immediately. What you’re doing is illegal, and I’ll make sure to sue all of you!

MARY
Look at you, acting like you’re someone important just because you’ve been gone a few years!

Mary sneers, shoving the diamond bracelet into Cash’s hands while glaring at Ava with disdain.

MARY (cont'd)
Take it, Cash. Let’s see what she thinks she can do about it.

Ava steps forward, trying to take back the jewelry. Cash shoves her away, but Ava retaliates by slapping him hard across the face. She grabs the jewelry from his hands.

CASH
You slapped me? You dare hit me?

AVA
Yes, I slapped you! What are you going to do about it?

CASH
Fine! I can’t handle you, but I’ll call Mike from the Young Group! He’s in charge of the factory construction in this town. He won’t let you off the hook!

AVA
Even if Mike comes, I’ll still stand my ground!

MARY
Shut your mouth! Apologize to Cash right now! You’re such a rude and ungrateful woman! Even the mayor shows Mike respect! And you're nothing compared to him.

AVA
Mike? Young Group? It doesn’t matter—he still has to answer to me!

MARY
Answer to you? Who do you think you are, the CEO of Young Group?

AVA
That’s exactly who I am.

Cash bursts out into mocking laughter.

CASH
You? A filthy liar claiming to be the CEO of Young Group? You’ve really lost it this time. Let’s see how long you can keep this up.

Cash pulls out his phone, ignoring Dora’s attempts to stop him. The call connects quickly.

CASH (cont'd)
Mike! There’s a shameless woman causing trouble here in our town and tarnishing its reputation. Can you come here and deal with her?

Cash ends the call and smirks maliciously at Ava.

EPISODE 17

37 EXT. CONSTRUCTION SITE - DAY 37

Mike slams down his helmet angrily after ending the call.

MIKE
How dare someone stir up trouble in my town? They must have a death wish!

Mike shouts to a group of WORKERS nearby.

MIKE (cont'd)
Grab your tools and follow me! Triple pay for today!

The workers drop what they’re doing, grabbing sticks, wrenches, and various tools before falling in line behind Mike. As he walks past the entrance, Mike grabs a steel pipe, holding it firmly as he storms out, leading the group with an intimidating presence.

38 EXT. MOUNTAIN ROAD - DAY 38

A car slowly navigates the winding mountain road.

39 INT. INSIDE CAR - DAY 39

Inside, Eric checks his phone one last time and sets it aside, looking impatiently at Gray.

ERIC
How much farther?

GARY
Boss, we should be there soon.

ERIC
Good. Drive faster!

40 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY 40

Cash glares at Ava with a triumphant expression.

CASH
You’re done for! Mike is on his way, and this time, you’re finished!

MARY
Just wait! If we can’t punish you ourselves, Mike will do it for us!

AVA
Grandma, didn't I already tell you? Even if Mike comes, he'll have to listen to me!

CASH
Ava, you venomous woman! It's not enough that you're ruining my Wedding—you want to bring down the entire town with you!

Worried, Dora moves closer to Ava, tugging on her sleeve.

DORA
Ava, Mike is not a good person! If he really shows up, what are we going to do?

Ava gently holds Dora's hand, giving her a reassuring smile.

AVA
Mom, do you remember what I said earlier? That I'm the CEO of Young Group?

DORA
You mean… you're Young Group's CEO?

Ava nods firmly.

AVA
That's right, Mom. I am the CEO of Young Group!

Dora's eyes widen in shock.

DORA
Ava! You're not joking, are you?

AVA
Not at all! I'm Mike's boss. What can he possibly do to me?

Relief washes over Dora's face, and she lets out a sigh.

DORA
That's wonderful! Now I can stop worrying!

Tony, however, steps forward, his face dark with concern.

TONY
No, this isn't good! What if Ava has already angered Mike? What if he refuses to build the factory?

NEIGHBOR A
Exactly! If the factory doesn't get built, all those jobs we were promised will disappear!

NEIGHBOR B
I've already invested in trucks for the factory's transport contracts. This can't happen!

TONY
We can't let this happen! We must stop anything that jeopardizes the factory!

EPISODE 18

41 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 41

Neighbor A and Neighbor B anxiously look at Tony.

NEIGHBOR A
Tony, if Mike really stops the construction, what are we going to do?

NEIGHBOR B
Exactly! Tony, you've got to think of something!

TONY
There's only one solution—Ava has to apologize to Mike! That's the only way to ensure the factory gets completed.

NEIGHBORS
Yes! Ava must apologize to Mike!

CASH
Mike will be here any minute! If you leave now, I'll pretend none of this happened and let you go.

AVA
You wish! I want to see what he thinks he can do to me!

TONY
Ava, you must apologize to everyone, especially Mike!

AVA
Tony, I suggest you wait. Once he's here, you'll see he's not someone I owe an apology to!

TONY
This is the rule of our town! You must comply!

AVA
So just for a factory project, you're willing to disregard right and wrong and force me to apologize?

TONY
Of course! If not, then leave right now! Cash, get her out of here!

Cash hesitates for a moment before stepping forward to grab Ava. She pushes him away firmly.

AVA
Get lost! Don't touch me!

Mary, furious, steps in to help Cash. She wrestles the bracelet away from Ava and quickly hands it to Anna, who gleefully stuffs it into her bag.

MARY
(glares at Ava)
Take it! Since you're determined to embarrass yourself today, don't blame me! Will you apologize or not?

AVA
Never! Don't even think about it!

TONY
This is your final chance—are you going to apologize?

AVA
Absolutely not.

TONY
Fine. Don't blame me for what happens next! Restrain her!

Several neighbors step forward, pulling Ava and Dora apart. Dora struggles, crying out.

DORA
Let go of my daughter!

MIKE (O.S.)
Everyone, stop what you're doing!

The crowd freezes, turning toward the entrance.

42 EXT. MOUNTAIN ROAD OUTSIDE THE TOWN - DAY

Several cars come to a halt along the winding mountain road. Men in white shirts, ties, and sunglasses step out from each vehicle. One of them opens the door for Eric, who quickly exits, his face filled with urgency.

43 EXT. AT THE WEDDING HALL ENTRANCE - DAY

The door of a van swings open, and Mike steps out, followed by 3 construction workers in uniforms carrying tools. Mike grabs a steel pipe from the van, striding into the courtyard with an imposing air.

MIKE
What the hell is going on here?!

EPISODE 19

44 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY 44

Mike strides in with an intimidating air.

CASH
Mike's here! Ava, you're done for!

Mike walks through the crowd, stopping right in front of Ava. Dora stands protectively beside Ava, clutching her arm tightly.

CASH (cont'd)
Mike! It's her! You need to teach her a lesson!

MIKE
Oh, so you think the people in this town are easy to bully? You deliberately cause trouble during someone's Wedding? Do you take us for fools?

Mary quickly steps forward, forcing a smile in an attempt to appease Mike.

MARY
Mike! It’s Ava... this vile woman, she’s the one tarnishing our town’s reputation!

Mike turns to Ava, narrowing his eyes.

MIKE
Why are you here causing trouble in my town? You’d better explain yourself, or…

Mike slams the steel pipe onto a table with a loud crash. Mary jumps in fright.

MARY
Teach her a lesson! Drive her out of the town!

Mary points a trembling finger at Ava, her voice suddenly icy.

MARY (cont'd)
Even though she’s my granddaughter, we’ve cut ties with her! She’s no longer family!

Ava stares at Mary, her expression calm but her voice cutting.

AVA
Grandma, you’re just afraid I’ll drag you down with me, aren’t you?

MARY
Shut your mouth!

CASH
Ava, you’re the one who’s done wrong! How dare you accuse Grandma? Everyone here has seen how cruel and selfish you are!

AVA
What a joke. You only care about yourselves. You never think about anyone else’s suffering. Mark my words—you’ll all face consequences for your actions one day.

CASH
You—

Before Cash can finish, Mike suddenly bursts into laughter. He steps closer to Ava, his face lighting up with amusement.

The two lock eyes, Ava standing her ground without flinching.

EPISODE 20

45 EXT. ROAD OUTSIDE AVA'S TOWN - DAY 45

Gary works hurriedly on repairing the car. Two rows of employees stand on either side of the road, unable to move as the cars behind are blocked. Eric paces impatiently, glancing at Gary.

ERIC
How much longer?

GARY
Boss, it'll take some more time. But there's only one road, so the cars behind us can't pass either.

Eric checks his watch, his expression tightening with urgency. He looks at the employees lined up, then makes a decision.

ERIC
There's no time! Everyone, follow me—run!

Without waiting, Eric starts running down the road. The employees exchange glances before quickly following him, running in formation behind their determined leader.

46 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY 46

Mike glares at Ava.

MIKE
Who are you?

AVA
I'm Cash's twin sister, Ava.

MIKE
Oh, I know you. You're the home-wrecking hooker, right?

AVA
Mike, I suggest you watch your mouth.

MIKE
Whatever. It’s none of my business. Just apologize, and we’ll call it a day.

Mike steps forward, reaching out to grab Ava, but she slaps his hand away forcefully.

AVA
Back off! Don’t touch me!

MIKE
You dare stop me? Alright, boys! Teach her a lesson!

Mike motions to the workers behind him, who start advancing. Suddenly, Dora rushes in, shielding Ava with her body. She stares at Mike, trembling but resolute.

DORA
Don’t you dare touch my daughter! If you have a problem, deal with me instead!

Mike points his steel pipe at Dora menacingly.

MIKE
Move out of the way, old woman. If I end up killing you, don’t blame me!

Though frightened, Dora doesn’t budge.

DORA
I won’t leave. I’ll protect my daughter no matter what.

MIKE
Fine. You asked for it! Boys, get them!

Mike’s men step forward, but Ava moves in front of her mother, stopping them in their tracks.

AVA
Mike! Do you even know who I am?

MIKE
Who you are? Ha! Let me guess...you’re going to claim you’re someone important?

AVA
That's exactly right. And if you lay a hand on me, you'll regret it for the rest of your life!

EPISODE 21

47 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 47

Mike bursts into loud laughter, mocking Ava.

MIKE
You'll make me regret it? What, have you been watching too many TV dramas?

CARL
Ava, shut your mouth! Mike is a big deal in our town! How dare you talk to him like that?

AVA
Big deal? I'm the biggest deal here!

MARY
You've clearly lost your mind! Stripping has made you delusional. What kind of "big deal" do you think you are?

CARL
I think it's been too long since you've been taught a lesson! That's why you're spouting nonsense!

Carl clenches his fist, blows on it, and steps toward Ava menacingly. Before he can reach her, Dora steps in between them, her arms spread protectively.

DORA
Carl! Don't hit Ava again!

CARL
Get out of my way! If I don't deal with her, are we all supposed to suffer because of her?

AVA
Oh, you want to hit me? Dad, do you still think it's eight years ago? I have nothing to do with you anymore!

Carl points a shaking finger at Ava, his face red with anger.

CARL
Ava, what did you just say? Say that again if you dare!

AVA
Why not? Go ahead and try to hit me! I'll sue you!

Ava's bold declaration silences the crowd. She points at Carl, Mary, and Cash in turn, her confidence unwavering. Carl stammers, too furious to form words.

CARL
You…! How could someone like you come from our family?

MARY
Oh, Lord! She's a demon! Why hasn't she gone straight to hell yet?

MIKE
You're calling yourself a "big deal"? Then tell me—what kind of "big deal" are you?

AVA
Nothing much. Just big enough to crush you, Mike.

MIKE
Crush me? You think you're above me? Everyone around here knows who I am!

CASH
Ava! You're just like a rabid dog! Let me tell you something—the CEO of Young Group is coming here today for my Wedding. Now that's a real big deal!

EPISODE 22

48 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 48

Ava looks at Cash, puzzled.

AVA
So you're saying, the reason why today's celebration is so grand… it's actually for me?

CASH
Are you deaf? What makes you think we'd prepare anything for you? It's for the CEO of Young Group!

NEIGHBOR A
I knew it! I was wondering why Cash's wedding was so extravagant. Turns out the CEO of Young Group is coming!

TONY
Cash, are you sure about this?

CASH
Of course I'm sure! Do you think I'd lie about something this important?

TONY
Wonderful! This is great news! Our town will become famous! Cash, you must convince the CEO to invest more in our town.

CASH
Don't worry, Tony. Leave it to me!

Mary nods in agreement, but then her expression darkens as she glares at Ava.

MARY
But you, Ava! This is Cash's Wedding. You're not welcome here!

Ava smirks sarcastically and lets out a soft sigh. Mary, enraged, steps closer.

MARY (cont'd)
What are you laughing at?

AVA
Are you sure you want me to leave? I am the CEO of Young Group. I even prepared an engagement gift—it's on its way.

Everyone freezes, stunned. Mike stares at Ava, his face filled with disbelief.

MIKE
You're saying… you're the CEO of Young Group?

EPISODE 23

49 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 49

Ava calmly meets Mike's incredulous gaze.

AVA
That's right. The factory construction project—you got that from me.

MIKE (V.O.)
Could she really be telling the truth?

Ava looks at Dora with a reassuring smile.

AVA
Since this wedding is supposedly prepared for me, Mom, let's go sit at the front!

Ava starts moving, but Tony steps forward, blocking her path, his face pale with fear.

TONY
Stop right there, Ava! Do you want to get us all killed?

AVA
What are you talking about?

TONY
That's the CEO's seat! If she arrives and sees you sitting there, she might cancel the factory project! What will we do then?

Ava smirks, unimpressed.

AVA
Tony, do you believe me when I say that with one phone call, I can cancel every project in this town?

Carl steps forward, furious, his fists clenched.

CARL
More nonsense! Tony, don't stop me! I'll teach her a lesson myself today!

AVA
All you ever do is hit me! I told you I've never sold my body or been with any married man. But you don't believe me.
(MORE)

AVA (CONT'D)
I told you I’m the CEO, and you don’t believe me. What exactly do you want from me?

EPISODE 24

50 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 50

Carl glares at Ava, his anger palpable. Mary steps forward, her expression stern.

MARY
Your father is right! Someone like you deserves a good beating!

CASH
What proof do you have that you’re the CEO?

AVA
And what proof do you have that I’m not?

Cash pulls Anna closer, and Anna smirks smugly at Ava.

CASH
Let me tell you the truth. Anna’s god-sister is the CEO of Young Group. How about that for proof?

Ava laughs in disbelief.

AVA
God-sister? I don’t remember having a god-sister like her!

CASH
Ava, you’re unbelievable! You’re just jealous of Anna. Let me make it clear: the only reason I have a job at Young Group is because Anna’s sister arranged it! You say you’re the CEO? Then why don’t I know about it?

AVA
Cash, are you an idiot? I’m the CEO. Do you think employees can just meet me whenever they want? And let me tell you something—your job? That was arranged by me!

Cash laughs coldly, pointing accusingly at Ava.

CASH
You arranged my job? Ava, you've deluded yourself so much you're starting to believe your own lies. You arranged my job? As if!

AVA
Cash, instead of mocking me, shouldn't you be thanking me for it?

Anna sneers and steps closer.

ANNA
Cash, look at the kind of person she is. After we get married, I don't want to see her ever again!

Cash nods quickly, eager to please.

CASH
Alright, alright! I promise she'll never show up again.

Anna turns to Ava, her tone dripping with disdain.

ANNA
Ava, if you insist you're the CEO, why don't you show us some proof?

AVA
That's easy. One phone call is all it takes to prove it.

EPISODE 25

51 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 51

Cash sneers at Ava, spreading his arms mockingly.

CASH
Go on, make the call. Let's see if you're for real!

ANNA
But what if the call doesn't go through? That'd be awkward!

AVA
Alright, watch closely. I'll make the call now.

Ava pulls out her phone and begins tapping on the screen. Cash and Mary exchange annoyed glances, growing impatient.

CASH
Oh, come on! Stop stalling and just make the call already!

ANNA
What's wrong? Can't keep up the act anymore?

Dora, visibly concerned, steps closer to Ava.

DORA
Ava, is everything okay?

AVA
The phone's out of battery.

Ava's calm statement draws scoffs from Anna, Cash, and Mary.

ANNA
Out of battery? How convenient!

DORA
Maybe you can use someone else's phone?

AVA
No need to worry, Mom. I've got another way.

ANNA
Another excuse? I think you're just too scared to make the call!

Cash laughs mockingly, his tone dripping with sarcasm.

CASH
Ava, you're really committed to this act, aren't you?

MIKE
Man, you almost had me fooled! For a second, I thought you might actually be Young Group's CEO!

Ava remains unfazed, her expression calm and confident.

AVA
Why are you all in such a rush? When the engagement gift arrives, you'll see what a real big deal looks like.

Anna smirks, throwing her bag full of cash at Cash, who catches it smugly and cradles it like a trophy.

ANNA
Fine, Ava. But if you're lying, you'd better be ready to face the consequences! I'll call my god-sister right now and show you what a real big deal looks like!

Anna pulls out her phone, her tone sharp as she speaks.

ANNA (cont'd)
(on the phone)
Sis! Someone here is pretending to be you. You'd better come over and put her in her place!

EPISODE 26

52 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 52

Anna holds up her phone, smugly listening as her god-sister's voice comes through the speaker.

SUE (V.O.)
What? Someone's pretending to be me? Let her wait! I want to see who has the nerve to pull this off!

Anna ends the call and smirks triumphantly at Ava.

ANNA
Ava, my sister's on her way. Let's see what you'll do now!

CASH
That's my babe! She can even get the Young Group's CEO to come here. Unlike Ava—shameless and nothing but a liar!

CARL
Anna, you're amazing! I'm looking forward to you officially joining our family!

Ava crosses her arms, her tone laced with sarcasm.

AVA
You're all so ridiculous. Being played and you don't even realize it!

CASH
Ava, that's enough! Don't make me hit you!

ANNA
Don’t bother. My god sister will be here soon, and then we’ll see how she talks her way out of this.

AVA
Great! I can’t wait to see what your “sister” looks like.

ANNA
If you apologize now, I might be willing to help plead your case.

MARY
Anna, you’re such a good girl! Ava, if anything ruins Cash’s Wedding because of you, I won’t forgive you!

AVA
Oh, it’s always about Cash, isn’t it? You never think about anyone else.

MARY
Of course! Why would I care about anyone else? Certainly not you!

Mike, who has been quietly simmering with frustration, finally snaps and shouts.

MIKE
Enough! Ava, are we going to settle our business now or not?

53 **EPISODE 27** 53

54 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 54

Ava stares at Mike, her gaze firm and unyielding.

AVA
We have nothing to talk about!

MIKE
Then you have two choices: apologize, or I’ll make you apologize!

AVA
Mike, if you dare lay a hand on me, I’ll make sure you regret it! Don’t forget—who gave you the project you’re working on right now?

MIKE
Who gave it to me? Obviously, the CEO of Young Group! What, you really think you're the CEO? You expect me to believe that?

ANNA
Mike, don't say I didn't warn you! If my sister shows up and sees this chaos, do you really think your project will continue?

TONY
No! The project mustn't stop! Mike, whatever it takes, you have to get Ava out of here!

CASH
Mike, enough talking! Let's get her!

MIKE
You! Bring Dora over here!

Ava struggles as she's dragged toward the gate. Dora clings to Ava, sobbing.

DORA
Leave her alone! Stop it!

Suddenly, a loud announcement echoes from the entrance.

VOICE (V.O.)
Gifts for the happy couple!

Everyone freezes, turning toward the sound. At the gate, three ATTENDANTS dressed in sleek black uniforms and wearing sunglasses enter, each carrying a meticulously wrapped gift. The crowd parts as they approach, their presence exuding formality and authority.

One of the ATTENDANTS steps forward and speaks in a clear, commanding voice.

ATTENDANT (V.O.)
In honor of Mr. Johnson's Wedding, the CEO of Young Group presents these gifts! Wishing Cash a happy engagement!

The crowd gasps, their eyes wide with shock as they stare at the lavish gifts presented before them. A wave of disbelief sweeps through the gathered townsfolk.

EPISODE 28

55 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 55

Ava approaches the gift bearers, looking at Tony and the others.

AVA
This is the engagement gift I've brought!

SERVANT 1
A luxury Miami oceanfront villa worth a hundred million. Wishing Mr. Johnson a blessed engagement.

NEIGHBOR 1
A beachfront villa! Something I wouldn't even dare dream about.

SERVANT 2
A complete set of porcelain from the British Royal Collection, the only one in the world, valued at fifty million. May Cash Johnson's marriage be full of light and love.

NEIGHBOR 2
Only the Queen of England would be worthy of such exquisite porcelain. Cash is truly blessed!

SERVANT 3
The long-lost Johnson family heirloom - a victory scepter made of ruby.

TONY
(excitedly)
Is this, is this truly our Johnson family's ancestral treasure?

AVA
Not a shadow of a doubt!

TONY
This is our town's most priceless artifact! The elders have always said - with this scepter, the entire family will be protected!

Carl and Cash look confused, Anna pointing at the gift in disbelief.

ANNA
How... how is this possible?

CASH
An ancestral treasure? Is this for real?

Everyone crowds around, Tony gazing at the ruby scepter with pure joy.

TONY
This is it! Crafted by the clan leader himself, our town's first mayor! Complete with our Johnson family crest! It was lost for years! I never thought I'd see it again in my lifetime!

Anna curiously reaches out to touch it, but Tony swats her hand away.

TONY (cont'd)
Keep your hands off it! This is our town's sacred treasure! If you damage it, could you possibly compensate such a loss?!

ANNA
I was just trying to look, Tony! Besides, what if Ava bought a cheap fake to fool everyone?

CASH
Yeah, Tony, Anna didn't mean any harm!

MARY
Based on what I know about Ava, these items could very well be counterfeits!

TONY
Enough! Questioning our town's treasures is an insult to our ancestors! Do you have a death wish?!

EPISODE 29

56 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 56

Mary's terrified.

MARY
Tony, we were wrong. Please spare us this time.

CASH
Yes, Tony, my grandma didn’t mean any harm. She did it for everyone's sake!

TONY
If they disrespect our forefathers again, I won’t be so lenient!

Mary nods continuously, too afraid to speak.

NEIGHBOR A
Even Tony is taking this seriously... This thing must truly be the gem of our town!

NEIGHBOR B
This thing must be priceless. If Ava managed to get it back, she must be really capable.

NEIGHBOR C
Could it be true? She’s actually a CEO out there?

AVA
Gifts! To the head table!

Ava leads the attendants carrying gifts. The crowd parts for her as they walk to the table, drop off the gifts, and leave. Ava turns to face everyone.

DORA
Eva, is this real?

AVA
Of course it is. Mom, I happened to get this for $200 million at an auction in Paris, so I brought it back today.

Dora's relieved, she tugs at Ava's hand.

DORA
Amazing, amazing! Carl! Mom! Do you see? Ava did this for us!

AVA
So, do you all still think I’m not the CEO of the company?

EPISODE 30

57 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 57

Mary continues to look at Ava with a face full of contempt.

MARY
So what if you're a CEO? Who knows how you got that title anyway!

CASH
Exactly! Everyone's saying you got there by whoring. Isn't that how you climbed your way up?

AVA
You’re truly beyond saving. It's a good thing I left long ago!

Carl points at Ava angrily.

CARL
How could I have raised a kid like you! How can I show my face again?!

CASH
Ava! Look how you’ve upset Dad!

AVA
You’re the ones with filthy minds! Have you ever believed a single word I’ve said?

MARY
Shut your mouth! I don't want to hear your dirty talk! You're Cash's sister. Take out your money, give it to your brother for his engagement!

AVA
No way! Eight years ago, I cut all ties with you!

MARY
I don’t want to waste my breath on you. Just give us your money now!

AVA
No! Not a single cent!

MARY
You’re going to drive me to my grave!

CASH
Ava, if it weren't for our family, could you have made it to college?

(MORE)

CASH (CONT'D)
Have we ever done you wrong? Shouldn't you be giving back to your family?

AVA
Money? I have plenty of it! But you're not getting a single penny! As for my mom, I'm taking her away. We're leaving this family for good!

EPISODE 31

58 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 58

Carl is even angrier now.

CARL
I should have buried you long ago!

MARY
Tony! Did you hear that? Someone like Ava should be driven out of town!

TONY
Ava, shut your trap! How could you speak like that to your grandma!

MARY
Yes, yes! People like her need to atone!

Tony nods in agreement.

TONY
You've got a point. This time, everyone must witness this. If everyone becomes like her, it will be too late!

Dora stops Tony when he finishes talking.

DORA
Tony! No! No whipping!
(to Ava)
Daughter, stop talking!

AVA
It's fine, Mom.
(looks at Tony)
Tony, this scepter, has it not been lost for hundreds of years?

TONY
It has.

AVA
And wasn't it me who brought it back?

TONY
That's right.

AVA
Since I'm the one who brought it back, doesn't that mean I've done a great service to the Johnsons?

TONY
You're not wrong. You are indeed a great benefactor to the town.

AVA
Since I've done such a great service, isn't it inappropriate to punish me? If you do, who would dare do good deeds for the town in the future?

MARY
Tony, don't listen to her!

TONY
Ava's right! She brought back our town heirloom. We have no reason to punish her!

EPISODE 32

59 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 59

Mary is shocked and tries to stop Tony.

MARY
Tony, don't listen to her—!

TONY
Shut up! Ava retrieved our heirloom for us—She's an honored guest! Do you have anything to say about that?

MARY
No... I don't...

TONY
Ava, since you brought back the Johnsons' heirloom, you should take the seat of honor—

Just then, Anna interrupts.

ANNA
Wait a minute! You've all been deceived by her!

TONY
What do you mean? Deceived?

ANNA
Because those gifts weren't brought by her at all!

NEIGHBOR A
Not brought by her? Then who did?

AVA
You're saying I didn't bring these gifts?

ANNA
Exactly! You can't fool me! These gifts were sent for Cash by the CEO of the Young Group! And Ava isn't the CEO! I just spoke to my sister on the phone, and she said these gifts are from her! Ava tricked all of you!

NEIGHBOR A
We were almost fooled by Ava!

NEIGHBOR B
Ava is so devious! What courage to impersonate the CEO!

MARY
Like I said! How could you have possibly become CEO? You're just a fraud! I'll teach you a lesson today!

Mary raises her cane and swings it toward Ava.

EPISODE 33

60 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 60

Dora rushes over and grabs the cane.

DORA
Mom! There must be some misunderstanding! Let Ava explain!

MARY
Explain what?! Get out of my way!

Mary forcefully pushes Dora aside. Ava quickly catches Dora, while Carl steps forward, clearly displeased.

CARL
Ava, you'll ruin us all! Tony, she's no grandchild of ours. I'll leave her to you to teach her a lesson!

TONY
Everyone!

Two neighbors grab Ava. Dora and Lily try to pull Ava away, but other Neighbors restrain them.

AVA
Mom! Mom! All of you, let me go!

Ava struggles fiercely, managing to throw off the two neighbors. She glares angrily at Tony, leaving Mary and Carl stunned. Ava walks toward Mary.

MARY
Ava, what do you think you’re going to do? You trying to hit me?

Ava says nothing. She turns and walks to the head table, picks up a wine bottle. Carl, frightened, tries to stop her.

CARL
Ava! What are you doing?! Didn’t I say that only the CEO can open that bottle of wine? Put it down!

Ava picks up the bottle, opens it, and slowly fills her glass, then raises it high above her head.

AVA
(to Carl)
Father, thank you for raising me all these years.

Carl has a complicated expression on his face, but he holds out his hand, ready to take the glass. Just as Carl' hand immediately touches the glass, Ava pulls his hand away and splashes the wine right in his face.

Mary, Carl, and Cash are all shocked by her actions.

MARY
Ava! Are you out of your mind?

EPISODE 34

61 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 61

Carl rushes forward and slaps Ava across the face.

CARL
You bitch! Making a fool of me in front of everyone!

Ava slams the wine bottle onto the ground with force, shattering it. Carl steps back, startled.

AVA
You've only ever cared about Cash since we were kids! I found a job, and you still wouldn't let me go! You insisted I marry a disgusting man like Tom! You wouldn't even get treatment for my mom, YOUR wife! All you care about is Cash! What am I to you?

CARL
So what if I favored him! Look what you've become!

AVA
Now it's your turn to pay your debts.

Carl is speechless, staring at Ava. Just then, Anna yells at Ava.

ANNA
Ava! What's wrong with you?! Wait until my god sister gets here, let's see how arrogant you'll be then!

AVA
She's not coming.

ANNA
What did you say?

AVA
I said, I'm the real CEO of the company.

ANNA
You've got some nerve!

AVA
You don't believe me? Fine. Call her over. Let's confront each other face-to-face.

SUE (O.S.)
Who is it? Who's the imposter? They must have a death wish!

Everyone looks toward the door as SUE HAYES (20-30s) struts in confidently.

NEIGHBOR A
Look, everyone! The CEO of Young Group!

NEIGHBOR B
Ava's in big trouble now, pretending to be her. I can't wait to see how she gets out of this one!

Sue walks up to Anna, who rushes over to greet her.

ANNA
Sister, you're finally here. You'd better give this bitch what for!

EPISODE 35

62 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 62

Sue looks down her nose at Ava with contempt.

SUE
What kind of place is this? It's filthy and rundown, reeks of poverty!

ANNA
Sister, I'm sorry to trouble you. Please, for my sake, bear with us and make the best of it!

SUE
Fine, since you're asking, I'll let it slide for your sake.

Anna smiles obsequiously at Sue, who looks visibly annoyed. Cash approaches Sue, smiling, to greet her.

CASH
Miss CEO, we've already received your engagement gift. We're eternally grateful!

Sue looks confused.

SUE
A gift?

CASH
The beachfront villa, royal china and ruby scepter. Wasn't that from you?

Sue quickly pretends it was her gift, acting nonchalant.

SUE
Oh, that? Just a little something, no big deal.

NEIGHBOR A
Wow, she really is the CEO! So different from the rest of us! Look, even something so valuable means nothing to her!

NEIGHBOR B
Well, of course! She's the CEO. People like us can't even compare!

TONY
Miss CEO, you've helped us recover our heirloom. On behalf of our town, I thank you.

SUE
Enough, it's just a small matter. No need to make such a fuss. Now, where's the person pretending to be me?

EPISODE 36

63 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 63

Anna, visibly agitated, approaches Sue while pointing accusingly at Ava.

ANNA
Sister! It's her, she's pretending to be you! You must set her straight!

Sue walks towards Ava with a smirk, as Dora quickly steps in front of Ava to block her.

SUE
So, you're the one impersonating me? I've got to hand it to you for your guts! You're the first one bold enough to try!

Ava stands her ground, facing Sue eye to eye.

AVA
I could ask you the same thing. Do you know the consequences of impersonating the CEO of Young Group?

DORA
Ava, what's going on here?

SUE
I am the CEO, no pretense here! But you, usurping my title, what are you trying to do?

AVA
I’ve barely said a word, what are you so upset for? Are you, perhaps, the real imposter?

ANNA
Ava, enough with your nonsense! The factory being constructed in our town was funded by my sister’s investment. How could she possibly be an imposter!

MARY
Ava, aren't you going to apologize to the CEO? If you upset her, I’ll have your dad break your legs!

AVA
Apologize to her? I can’t tell if you’re really that clueless or just pretending! She's just a fake, she doesn't deserve any respect!

MARY
Slandering the CEO? I’ll rip your tongue out!

Mary attempts to strike Ava but is shoved away by Ava. Dora quickly stands behind Ava.

MARY (cont'd)
You dare fight back? You!

AVA
You think it’s like when I was a kid? You can just hit me whenever you want?

MARY
Miss CEO! Look at her! She's not taking you seriously at all! We need to teach her a lesson!

SUE
Ava, right? Well, now I'm really mad! Maybe we don't need to continue this factory construction after all!

EPISODE 37

64 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 64

Tony anxiously rushes up to Sue.

TONY
Miss CEO, you can't! The factory project must not stop!

NEIGHBOR A
Yes! Ms. CEO, if you stop the construction, our livelihoods go with it!

NEIGHBOR B
CEO! It's Ava who offended you, you can't punish us too!

SUE
Well, then don't blame me for this. Blame her!

TONY
Ava, look what you've done! Aren't you going to kneel to the CEO?

NEIGHBOR A
Yeah, if you want to die, don't drag us all down with you!

NEIGHBOR B
Such a disgrace! She should be kicked out of our town!

NEIGHBORS
Get out! Get out! Get out!

Sue smirks triumphantly at Ava, who coldly stares back.

AVA
If you really drive me away, the town's factory project will be doomed!

MARY
Ava, do you think we're all fools? Who would believe that? Get down on your knees and apologize to the CEO! If not, I'll deal with you yet!

AVA
Impossible!

TONY
Carl, your daughter's going to be the death of our town!

CARL
Ava, you think I won't make a move on you?

Ava looks at Carl but doesn’t move, which angers him more.

MIKE
Ava, you even dare piss off the CEO? Well I’m pissed off too! Miss CEO, don’t worry. This bitch crossed you, I’ll make sure she’s dealt with today!

SUE
So you’re Mike Williams?

MIKE
Yes, yes! I just got a call from the president, asking me to protect you! I knew you were coming, so I waited here especially for you!

SUE
Well done!

MIKE
So, Miss CEO, about the factory project... would you reconsider?

SUE
Ah, that... let’s see how you perform today, shall we?

MIKE
Understood! Don’t worry, CEO, I’ll make sure you’re satisfied!

Mike gestures to several workers.

MIKE (cont'd)
You guys, come here! Make her kneel and apologize to the CEO! There'll be double pay for you today!

EPISODE 38

65 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 65

The workers rush over and grab Ava, who starts to struggle.

AVA
What are you doing! Let go of me!

DORA
Don't touch my daughter!

66 EXT. MOUNTAIN ROAD, NEAR AVA'S TOWN - DAY

Eric and Gary are panting as they run. Suddenly, Gary points ahead excitedly.

GARY
Boss! We made it!

Eric's legs give out from exhaustion, and Gary supports him.

ERIC
Thank God, we're here! Ava must have been waiting for ages! Let's go!

Eric rushes up, followed closely by EMPLOYEES.

67 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY 67

Mary strides forward, shoving Dora aside.

MARY
Get out of my way!

DORA
Mom! They're bullying Ava!

MARY
Shut up! You always take her side! I'll beat you dead!

Mary raises her cane and strikes Dora, causing her to cry out in pain. Ava shouts in desperation.

AVA
Don’t touch my mom!

The cane hits Dora repeatedly. Dora screams.

AVA (cont'd)
Grandma! Stop hitting my mom!

Mary doesn't stop. She swings her cane fiercely at Dora as Lily tries to hold her back. Mary, furious, points at Lily.

MARY
You little bitch! I’ll beat you too!

Mary raises her cane to strike Ava. Dora shields her.

AVA
Don’t hit her! Mom! Mom!

ANNA
See, Ava? This is what happens to those who pretend to be my sister!

CASH
Miss CEO, you’re something else. One word, and you’ve put her in her place!

Mike places a stool behind Sue and wipes it off with his sleeve.

MIKE
CEO, please sit! And about the project...?

SUE
You did well. The project can continue.

Sue sits down contentedly. Mike bows gratefully.

MIKE
Thank you, CEO! Thank you!

Ava glares at Sue, seething with anger.

AVA
I’ll make you regret this... you’ll pay the price!

Mike laughs mockingly and takes a stick from someone nearby, pointing it at Ava.

MIKE
Oh, daring to threaten the CEO? I’ll finish you off myself!

EPISODE 39

68 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 68

Just then, Sue raises her hand to stop everyone.

SUE
Wait!

Sue stands up from her seat.

SUE (cont'd)
Let her go!

Ava breaks free from those holding her and immediately steps in front of Dora. She eyes Sue warily.

AVA
What do you want?

SUE
You said you won't let me get away with this?

AVA
You impersonated me as CEO, and you bullied my mom!

SUE
I'm the real CEO of Young Group. I'd love to see how you're going to stop me!

ANNA
Oh wow, you really don't hold back, do you? A lowly stripper like you, talking big, it's laughable!

CASH
Babe, you're right! Did you get scared stupid, Ava? Have you convinced yourself that you're actually a CEO?

AVA
Just you wait! Soon, I'll make sure every one of you pays for what you did today!

MARY
Shut your mouth! If you want to throw your life away, fine! But don't drag us down with you!

CARL
I swear, I'll beat you to death!

AVA
Go ahead! Try it!

From the side, Sue watches with amusement, clapping her hands slowly.

SUE
Good, good! I'd love to see how you plan to take me down! Oh, my shoes are dirty. Ava, get down on your knees and lick them clean!

EPISODE 40

69 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 69

Sue extends her foot, motioning toward Ava. Anna eagerly nods beside her.

ANNA
Yes, yes, sis! Make her lick them!!

Anna supports Sue and steps back.

ANNA (cont'd)
Come on, let's avoid the glass shards. Wouldn't want to cut our feet.

DORA
What? You want her to kneel on that? Miss CEO, the ground is covered in glass—just one touch, and they'll pierce her skin! I beg you, please spare my daughter!

Dora moves forward to grab Sue's hand, but Sue quickly shoves her away.

SUE
Get away from me! You stink of poverty, it's disgusting!

Sue dusts off the spot where Dora touched her, sniffing herself in disgust, her face wrinkling in distaste.

MARY
This is the CEO's decision! Keep your mouth shut!

AVA
I'm warning you, don’t go too far!

ANNA
Too far? You impersonated my sister! You deserve every bit of this!

CASH
That’s right! Ava, if you wanna sell your body for a living, whatever! But pretending to be some big-shot CEO? Newsflash, you'll never be CEO in your lifetime!

AVA
Cash, you better watch your mouth!

CASH
You know why Dad and Grandma favored me all these years? Because even they knew you were nothing but trash!

Ava, unable to hold back anymore, slaps Cash hard across the face. Cash holds his cheek in disbelief, staring at Ava.

CASH (cont'd)
You dare hit me?!

EPISODE 41

70 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 70

Cash lunges toward Ava, but Dora steps in to block him.

DORA
Don’t you lay a hand on her!

CASH
Mom, get out of the way. This is none of your business! I’m going to beat her to death!

DORA
She’s your little sister!

CASH
I don’t have a sister like her!

SUE
Enough! Are you all ignoring what I said? I told her to kneel! You can fight among yourselves at home!

MIKE
Everybody stop! Handle your family drama on your own time!
(To Ava)
You! Kneel to the CEO right now!

CASH
Ava, didn’t you want to be a CEO? Here’s your chance to get a taste... of the CEO’s shoes!

AVA
Why should I kneel to her?

CASH
What? You, the great CEO of Young Group, can’t kneel?

ANNA
You filthy whore! You should be honored to kneel before my sister! Now get down!

SUE
That’s right. Kneel now, lick my shoes clean, and I’ll let today’s incident slide.

MARY
You heard her! Kneel to the CEO!

CASH
Didn’t you hear? Kneel down and lick her shoes!

Ava stares at Sue.

AVA
I suggest you think carefully. You’re impersonating the CEO of Young Group, which is already unforgivable. Now you expect me to kneel and lick your shoes? You should weigh the consequences of what you're doing!

SUE
What gives you the right to say I’m an imposter? I am the CEO of Young Group!

AVA
Imposter or not... you know perfectly well which one you are.

As Ava speaks, Sue becomes visibly nervous, her eyes shifting as she avoids Ava's gaze.

EPISODE 42

71 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 71

For a brief moment, Sue’s nervousness flashes across her face, but she quickly regains her domineering composure.

SUE
Kneel now, or say goodbye to that factory project!

A few more people step forward and grab Ava. Mike looks at her angrily.

MIKE
Ava, if you don’t kneel right now and my project falls through, I swear you’ll pay for it!

TONY
You damned liar! Kneel to the CEO!

CASH
Kneel!

MARY
You better get on your knees!

NEIGHBORS
Kneel! Kneel! Kneel!

AVA
Let go of me!

Dora rushes to Ava’s side, crying out to everyone.

DORA
Stop bullying my daughter! I’ll kneel for her! Miss CEO, my daughter has offended you, I’ll kneel for her.

SUE
Alright, go ahead. Kneel for her and lick my shoes clean, and I’ll let her go.

AVA
Mom! Don't!

MARY
You crazy woman! What's this got to do with you?!

CARL
If you're going to kneel, do it quickly! And let's be clear—if anything happens, don't expect me to pay for your medical bills!

DORA
Mom, Carl! Ava is my daughter, I can't just stand here and watch her be bullied. Even if I die today, I'll protect my daughter!

AVA
Mom! You can't kneel!

SUE
Enough with the chatter! Is she going to kneel or not? If she doesn't, I'll make Ava kneel instead!

Sue looks at Dora, then gestures for Ava to kneel. Dora immediately drops to her knees.

DORA
I'll kneel!

EPISODE 43

72 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 72

Dora is about to kneel, the surrounding people remain indifferent. Sue's face lights up with a smug smile, eagerly watching Dora.

AVA
Mom, you can't kneel! Get up, Mom!

Dora kneels on the shards of broken glass, her face contorts in pain, but she holds back any sound. Ava cries out as she sees this.

AVA (cont'd)
No! Mom! Mom!

Dora reaches out, carefully using her sleeve to wipe Sue's high heels.

AVA (cont'd)
Mom! You don't have to kneel! Mom!

Dora grits her teeth, focusing on cleaning Sue’s shoes. Still kneeling, she looks up at Sue with a tearful expression.

SUE
Use your tongue!

Dora is doubly humiliated, but she gradually bends down closer to Sue's shoes.

Dora lifts her head, with thin traces of blood on the corners of her mouth, and looks up at Sue.

DORA
(crying)
CEO, can you let my daughter go now?

SUE
(scornfully)
Alright, alright. Let's consider today's issue dealt with.

Dora slowly stands up.

DORA
Thank you, Miss CEO.

Dora turns to look at Ava. The people holding Ava let her go.

DORA (cont'd)
Ava, thank Miss CEO.

AVA
Mom, don’t thank her! She’s not the CEO! She’s been lying to you! Sue! After what you did to my mother, I’ll make you pay!

CASH
Still talking big! Look what you’ve done to Mom already!

AVA
And you! I won’t let you get away with it either!

MARY
Hmph! Threatening your brother? Carl! Teach her a lesson!

Carl walks up to Ava, pointing at her and yelling.

CARL
No respect for your elders! I’ll beat you to death!

Ava shows no fear, taking out her phone and dialing 911. She holds it up for Carl to see.

AVA
You dare hit me! I'll call the cops right now!

CARL
I'm your father! You'd call the police on me?!

AVA
You're not fit to be my father!

Ava turns her gaze to Sue.

AVA (cont'd)
For everything you've done, I'll make sure you pay back double!

Ava pulls out her phone and starts dialing.

EPISODE 44

73 EXT. MOUNTAIN ROAD, NEAR AVA'S TOWN - DAY

Eric and his MEN are struggling to make their way through thick brush. Suddenly, Eric's phone RINGS. He quickly pulls it out, glances at the screen, and his face lights up with joy.

ERIC
(answers phone)
Ah! Ava! You finally picked up! I've been so worried!

AVA (O.S.)
Where are you! My mom and I are being bullied to death!

ERIC
Someone dares to mess with my wife? I won't forgive them! Honey, hang tight! I'm coming right now!

Eric hangs up the phone, now looking frantic. He shouts to his team.

ERIC (cont'd)
Everyone! Get to the town as fast as you can! Whoever touched my woman, I want them dead!

74 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 74

Ava hangs up the phone.

AVA
Just wait! I've already called my husband!

The neighbors laugh, clearly not taking Ava seriously.

ANNA
You're a hooker! Calling some client your husband I bet! I don't know where you got the nerve to make that call!

MARY
You have no shame! Calling your sugar daddy—absolutely nasty!

CARL
You dare bring some sicko here and shame us?! I'll break both your legs in front of everyone!

AVA
I suggest you all watch your mouths. Do you even know who my husband is? Keep talking, and when he gets here, you'll all regret it!

ANNA
Even if some big shot shows up, my sister's here - the CEO of Young Group! I'm not scared of anyone!

AVA
Her? My husband wouldn't throw a single glance her way!

ANNA
What did you say? Say that again! How dare you insult my sister and the CEO!

AVA
I just did. What about it?

SUE
By the way you're talking, it seems your husband's quite a public figure! I'm curious—who is he, exactly, that's given you such confidence?

AVA
My husband's name is Eric Young!

EPISODE 45

75 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 75

Ava stands firm, showing no fear or respect toward Sue.

AVA
My husband's name is Eric Young! Now do you see why I have confidence?

Everyone bursts out laughing again. CASH purposely questions Ava.

CASH
What did you say? What's your husband's name?

AVA
Eric Young!

CASH
Your husband is Eric Young? You're killing us over here!

AVA
Why? You don't believe me?

CASH
No, no, no, it's not that I don't believe you. It's that it's absolutely impossible!

ANNA
Everybody knows that Eric is the president of Young Group, and his wife is the CEO of the company! So if you're his wife, what does that make my sister?

MARY
Of all the people you could've named, you had to pick the chairman of Young Group!

CARL
Shameful! Absolutely shameful!

Dora looks at Ava, deeply concerned.

DORA
Ava, you can't joke about this!

AVA
Mom, trust me! Everything I'm saying is the truth!

ANNA
Sis! She's not only pretending to be you, she's claiming that Eric is her husband! You can't let her get away with this!

SUE (V.O.)
As far as I know, Eric Young is on a business trip. There's no way he could be here, so nothing she says is true!

SUE
Ava, since you seem to know so much, you should know the consequences if my husband finds out your lie. Are you not afraid?

AVA
Afraid? He's my husband! Why would I be scared? He'll be here in about 10 minutes. Once he shows up, I'd like to see how much longer you can keep up this act!

EPISODE 46

Sue's smile falters for a second but she quickly recovers and fires back at Ava.

SUE
Act? What act? He's my husband, what's there for me to be afraid of? But you—you're the one who's lying!

ANNA
Exactly! If my sister wasn't here today, you would've fooled everyone!

AVA
We'll find out the truth soon enough.

ANNA
Fine! Let's wait! Who's afraid of who? When Eric really shows up, I want to see how you keep up that attitude!

SUE
There's no need to wait. He's not coming.

(MORE)

SUE (CONT'D)
My husband is abroad on a business trip, there's no way he'd come to a small town like this. Ava, you put on a good show, but looks like you missed a spot in your research.

Anna pulls out her phone, scrolling through it. Ava smirks coldly.

AVA
I didn't expect this, but alright. In that case, how about we make a bet?

SUE
A bet? What kind of bet?

AVA
Let's bet on whether Eric will arrive within 10 minutes!

SUE
Fine! I'll take that bet!

ANNA
Ava, you're going to lose! I just looked it up — the president is currently on a business trip abroad. Forget 10 minutes, he won't even make it in 10 days!

SUE
See? Even the internet says so. What do you have to say for yourself now?

AVA
Believe what you want. Oh, and before we settle this, I have a gift for both of you.

Sue's face twists in disdain, and Anna looks unfazed. Just then, Ava's phone RINGS. She answers it and speaks into the phone.

AVA (cont'd)
Terminate Anna's employment immediately. And cancel Cash's job offer as well!

EPISODE 47

76 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 76

Ava is on her phone, speaking into it.

AVA
Neither of these two people is ever to be hired by Young Group or any company in the industry again!

Ava hangs up the phone and looks at Anna.

AVA (cont'd)
You’re both fired.

ANNA
What? Ava, both my job and Cash’s position were personally arranged by my sister! She’s standing right here! You think you can just fire us? You’ve got to be kidding!

CASH
Ava, you really do put on a great show. But Sue’s the CEO! How could she possibly fire us?

SUE
That’s right! As long as I’m here, no one can fire them!

Anna laughs confidently, but just then, her phone RINGS. She quickly answers it.

MALE EXECUTIVE (O.S.)
I’m sorry, but you’ve been terminated.

ANNA
What? That’s impossible!

CASH
Babe, what happened?

ANNA
I’ve really been fired!

CASH
What...?

At that moment, Cash’s phone RINGS as well. He quickly pulls it out.

MALE EXECUTIVE (O.S.)
I’m sorry, your job offer has been rescinded.

CASH
How could that happen!

Cash tries to respond, but the call abruptly ends. Mary looks at her grandson, concerned.

MARY
Cash, what's going on?

CASH
My job offer was canceled!

AVA
Now do you believe me?

MARY
Tell me! What did you do? What tricks did you pull to get my grandson's job canceled?

AVA
What could I have done? Your precious grandson just didn't measure up. The company didn't want him enough, so they canceled his offer. What does that have to do with me?

MARY
I don't care! Whatever you did, you have to fix it!

AVA
Grandma, I'm nothing compared to your golden grandson. He's so exceptional, let him figure it out himself!

EPISODE 48

77 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 77

Mary is furious, yelling at Ava.

MARY
If Cash knew what to do, why would I come to you?! Besides, he's your brother! It's your duty to help him!

ANNA
Sis! How on earth did this happen?

CASH
(To Sue)
Yeah, yeah, aren't you the CEO of Young Group? How could Ava just say a few words and get both of us fired?

SUE (V.O.)
She can't really be the CEO, right? That doesn't make sense. If she were the CEO, how could she not know the president is on a business trip? It's a coincidence, yeah, just a coincidence!

Sue, though unsure, tries to regain control.

SUE
What are you two so flustered about? I arranged for this to happen.

ANNA
Why? We didn't do anything wrong!

CASH
Yeah! You can't just fire us for no reason!

SUE
Look at you two—so pathetic! It's just getting fired, what's the big deal? Young Group is opening a new branch, and I'm planning to make you both the managers. Of course, they had to fire you first to make that happen!

Ava finds this laughable, shaking her head with a smirk. But Anna and Cash believe her and excitedly thank her.

ANNA
Thank you, sister! I knew it—you always look out for me!

MARY
Wonderful, wonderful! My dear grandson, you've made it big! You're about to open a new branch! You're the pride of your grandma, my precious!

CARL
Cash, you're a worthy son! I knew you could do it!

Sue looked at Ava with a malicious grin and pointed at her.

SUE
Tie her up and give her a good beating!

Mike waves his hand, signaling for the workers.

MIKE
Hold them down!

DORA
No! Don’t!

Dora steps in front of Ava, but the WORKERS quickly pull them apart.

EPISODE 49

78 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 78

Ava glared at Sue with fierce hostility.

AVA
Let us go! Or my husband won’t spare you!

CARL
You’re still thinking about that pervert client of yours? You must be out of your mind! WHORE!

MARY
Since she thinks about pleasing men 24/7, why don’t we just marry her off to some random guy to save ourselves the embarrassment?

SUE
That makes sense. If I recall correctly, there's a crippled homeless guy in the next town, right? Let's marry this bitch off to him!

MARY
Yes, yes! The CEO’s right! We’ll do whatever you say! And in return, please look out for our dear Cash!

SUE
Of course! But before we do that, let’s make sure she gets a good beating to vent my anger!

MIKE
CEO, don’t worry! I’ll make sure you’re satisfied! Everyone, get to work!

AVA
Mike! If you dare touch them, I'll make sure you regret it!

Mike walks over to Ava and slaps her hard across the face.

MIKE
Still got something to say, huh?
(to the Workers)
Come on, hold her mother down first!

Dora is forced to her knees, kneeling on the shards of broken glass.

AVA
Mom! Mike, let her go!

MIKE
What are you staring at? Looks like you need a proper beating! I'll handle it myself!

Mike steps forward and grabs Ava.

AVA
Don't touch me!

MIKE
Kneel!

Sue watches from the side, laughing out loud.

SUE
Good, good! Mike, you're doing great! I have high hopes for you!

MIKE
It's my duty to serve the CEO, isn't it?

SUE
I have plenty of projects coming up. From now on, I'll give them all to you!

MIKE
Thank you, Miss CEO! I'll never forget your kindness!

Mike presses hard on Ava's head, pressing her against the glass shards as Ava desperately resists, letting out a cry of pain.

AVA
Mike! All of you! I'll remember every single one of you! I'll make sure you pay back double for what you've done to me and my mom!

EPISODE 50

79 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 79

Mike is startled, his hand loosens. Sue glares at Ava, even angrier.

SUE
You dare threaten me? Mike, what are you doing! You can't even handle a woman? How can I trust you with any projects after this!

MIKE
Miss CEO, don't be angry! Just watch me, I won't let you down!

Mike presses down even harder, trying to force Ava's face into the glass shards. Ava struggles fiercely, groaning in pain, trying to keep her face away from the glass.

Just then, Eric storms in, radiating fury.

ERIC
Every single one of you here—if you laid a finger on my wife, you're dead!

EPISODE 51

80 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 80

Eric's entrance shocks everyone.

NEIGHBOR A
That's Eric! The president of Young Group!

NEIGHBOR B
It's him! It's really him! I've seen him before on TV!

ANNA
What's going on? Wasn't president Yang supposed to be on a business trip? Why would he show up here?

CASH
Anna, what's happening?

ANNA
I don't know!

Eric spots Mike pressing Ava down. Furious, he charges forward and kicks Mike away.

ERIC
You bastard! How dare you touch my wife! Ava, are you okay? I'm so sorry! I'm so sorry Ava!

Ava's knees are bleeding. Eric helps her up, but without saying much, Ava quickly rushes to help Dora up.

AVA
Mom! Are you alright?

Dora nods. Ava then turns to Eric, her expression fierce, and calls his name angrily.

AVA (cont'd)
Eric!

ERIC
I should have been here sooner. I'm sorry—it's my fault you and your mom were bullied.

AVA
I want every single one of them who hurt us to pay the price!

EPISODE 52

81 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 81

Sue is terrified, flustered. Eric grabs Ava's arm.

ERIC
Don't worry! Every single person who hurt my wife today, don't even think about leaving.
(turns to the others)
Get them! Beat them up!

Eric points at Mike, who is still lying on the ground. Just then, 4 of Eric's men, dressed in white shirts, rush in through the gate. They surround Mike and start beating him.

MIKE
President! I’m sorry! I’m sorry!

ERIC
Mike, right? You dared to bully my wife—unforgivable! And when you took on contracts for Young Group, you oppressed workers, refused to pay wages, and even broke several laws! I’ve already handed over evidence of your crimes to the authorities. You’ll face justice under the law!

The 4 men step away as Mike collapses on the ground, looking up at Eric.

ERIC (cont'd)
And all of you, scumbags, just like Mike here! You won’t get away with this. You’re all going to jail!

Mike's workers are scared speechless. Nearby, Sue is panicking, her eyes darting around. Anna tugs on Sue’s arm.

ANNA
Sis, what’s going on? Isn’t Eric your husband? What is happening?

CASH
Yeah, aren’t you supposed to be the CEO?

SUE
Uh, I have something urgent to attend to. I should go!

Sue quickly turns around and tries to leave.

EPISODE 53

82 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 82

Just as Sue turns to leave, Ava shouts.

AVA
Stop right there!

SUE
What do you want?

AVA
I told you, anyone who’s wronged me will pay!

(MORE)

AVA (CONT'D)
(turning to the employees)
Hold her down!

Eric’s employees rush forward, grabbing Sue as she struggles to break free.

SUE
Let go of me!

Ava points to the pile of broken glass on the ground in front of her.

AVA
Hold her down right there!

SUE
No! Let go! Let me go!

Sue, terrified, struggles even harder, but the employees drag her over to the spot Ava pointed to and force her down.

AVA
Push her down!

SUE
No! No!

As Sue’s face inches closer to the shards of glass, Dora turns to Ava.

DORA
Ava, are you really the CEO?

AVA
I am. Mom, this is Eric, the president of Young Group. Go ahead, Eric, greet your mother-in-law.

ERIC
Hi, Mom!

DORA
Oh, what a good boy!

Meanwhile, Anna, Cash, Carl, and Mary stand off to the side, visibly scared, not daring to move.

ANNA
You really are the CEO?

AVA
What do you think?

CASH
Sister! I misunderstood you! I never thought after so many years away, you'd come back so powerful! You've even become the CEO!

MARY
Why didn’t you tell us sooner? If you had, we wouldn’t have had all these misunderstandings, right?

AVA
I told you so many times! Did any of you believe me? In your eyes, how could I possibly be a CEO? Aren’t I just a despicable, shameless home-wrecking hooker?

EPISODE 54

Mary forces a fake smile at Ava.

MARY
Ava! We’re all family! This is all a misunderstanding!

CASH
Ah, yes, yes! Today is still my wedding, and you've actually become the CEO of Young Group! We should have a proper celebration!

Carl turns to face the Neighbors, a bit nervous, speaking to them awkwardly.

CARL
Everyone! Let's celebrate my daughter Ava, who’s become the CEO of Young Group!

NEIGHBORS
Congratulations, Ava!

AVA
Did you all forget something? I’ve already disowned all of you!

CASH
Sister, what are you saying? Our neighbors are all here. Can’t you show Dad and Grandma some respect?

ANNA
Ava! So what if you're a CEO? What's so great about that? Why are you acting all high and mighty?

CASH
Exactly! Don't think just because you're a CEO, you can fly to the moon or something. Let me remind you, you're still family, and Dad and Grandma will always be your elders!

MARY
You think having money makes you special? If it weren't for us raising you, would you be where you are today? You want to cut ties? Fine, give $10 million to Cash, and we'll sever our ties!

As soon as Mary says this, Cash lights up with excitement, looking at her expectantly.

EPISODE 55

83 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 83

Carl steps forward.

CARL
You don't want to acknowledge me or Grandma? Sure, as long as you give your brother 10 million, I don't give a shit either way!

CASH
Anna! Did you hear that? 10 million! We can do whatever we want!

ANNA
Ava! Hand over the money! With 10 mil, I'll marry your brother right away!

AVA
No! Not a single cent!

CARL
What did you just say?

MARY
You've got so much money—what's giving away 10 million to you? It's your duty to help your brother out!

AVA
I do have money! But asking me for 10 million? How do you even have the nerve?

Carl is about to step forward when Eric moves in and blocks his path.

ERIC
Don't you dare! I'm only showing you respect because you're Ava's father. But Ava is my wife! If you lay another hand on her, don't think I'll let it slide!

Carl, intimidated, backs down but yells at Ava.

CARL
Ava, tell me! Are you sure you want to cut ties with us?

AVA
Yes! I'm cutting ties with you!

MARY
Shut up! I don't care if you cut ties or not! You're still giving us that 10 million! As long as you're standing here, you're part of this family, and you will give your brother the money!

EPISODE 56

84 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 84

CARL
I will always be your father! Mary will always be your grandmother! Today, you either hand over the money, or don't even think of taking a step out of this town!

CASH
Ava! Did you hear that? Cut the crap and give us the money!

MARY
There are plenty of Johnsons in the world! If you don't give us the money, I'll spread the word about you! Let everyone see what kind of person you really are!

(MORE)

MARY (CONT'D)
Let’s see who will still want to associate with someone as cold and heartless as you!

CASH
Ava, you’re the CEO of a conglomerate! If word gets out about this, it won’t look good for you!

AVA
You’re using our family to threaten me? Fine! Today, I’ll sever these blood ties in front of our ancestors!

Ava grabs a knife from a table and cuts off a lock of her hair. **(This can be changed.)**

Ava opens her hand, the hair floats to the ground.

AVA (cont'd)
From this day forth, we’re done!

EPISODE 57

85 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 85

MARY
You’ll be the death of me! How could I have a granddaughter like you?!

CARL
God! Is this the retribution I’m to suffer?!

Ava looks directly at Carl.

AVA
From now on, we have nothing to do with each other!

Tony, trying to be conciliatory, approaches Ava.

TONY
Ava, it’s all your Dad and grandma’s fault! It has nothing to do with us! You grew up here, so you have to keep funding the factory!

AVA
Still thinking about the factory project? Have you forgotten how you all treated my mom?

TONY
We didn't know! We were misled by those nasty rumors! Otherwise, we never would've misunderstood you!

NEIGHBOR A
That's right, Ava, we were tricked!

NEIGHBOR B
You can't abort the project!

AVA
This project is not going forward! Mom, let's go.

Ava pulls Dora along as they head towards the exit. Neighbor A points accusingly at Carl

NEIGHBOR A
It's all because of Carl and his ilk! If it weren't for them, we never would've misunderstood Ava!

NEIGHBOR B
Exactly! They've ruined our chance at success! We should teach them a lesson!

NEIGHBORS
Punish them! Beat them!

The neighbors turn on Carl, Cash, and the others, surrounding them as Ava helps Dora walk away.

EPISODE 58

86 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 86

Dora glances back, unable to ignore the sight of Cash being beaten. She grabs Ava's arm.

DORA
Ava, maybe you should help your brother out? I'm worried...

ERIC
Mom! Don't worry. I've got people keeping an eye on things. They'll be fine—at most, they'll just get a little punishment.

DORA
But…

AVA
Mom! There's no "but" here! Have you forgotten how he treated you? He never saw you as family!

ERIC
Mom, just come with us. Ava and I will definitely take good care of you.

DORA
Alright, I'll listen to you both.

AVA
Let's go.

Ava and Eric finally smile, and the three of them prepare to leave. Suddenly, Cash breaks free from the people attacking him and runs to block Ava's path.

CASH
Ava, don't go! Give me the money first!

ANNA
Yeah! Give us the money!

ERIC
You still dare to come at us? Looks like you haven't learned your lesson yet! Get them!

4 men step forward, but before they act, TWO MEN in blue uniforms enter the yard.

STAFF MEMBER A
Anyone here by the names of Cash and Anna?

DORA
What's going on?

STAFF MEMBER A
They've racked up $10 million in gambling debts and went MIA! Now their creditors have called the police, and we need to take them away.

DORA
Cash, is this true?

CASH
Mom, it's true.

Carl and Mary are too shocked to speak. Mary suddenly bursts into tears.

MARY
God, why is this happening?!

Overcome with emotion, Mary suddenly freezes and collapses. The crowd rushes over to check on her.

DORA
Mom! Mom!

CARL
Cash! You—

Before Carl can finish his sentence, he too stumbles and falls to the ground.

EPISODE 59

87 INT. WEDDING HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 87

Dora rushes to Carl, panic-stricken.

DORA
Carl! Mom!

TONY
Quick! Get them to the hospital!

The people at the scene help carry Carl and Mary out of the yard. As the crowd begins to leave, Dora walks over to Cash.

DORA
Cash, how could you do this? Your dad and grandma treated you so well, spent all their money on you! How could you do something like this?!

CASH
Mom! Mom! I'm sorry! Won't you help me out? Huh?

Dora looks at Ava.

DORA
Ava? Cash is your brother after all...

AVA
Mom, let's go!

Cash grabs Ava, kneeling at her feet.

CASH
Ava! I was wrong! I was truly wrong! We're at the end of the road. I don't want to go to jail! Help me out, okay?

AVA
Not a chance!
(turning to the authorities)
Their crimes have nothing to do with us. Please, take them away.

The staff members take out handcuffs, securing Cash and leading him away. Anna is also cuffed and dragged along.

CASH
No! Ava! Miss CEO! I'm sorry, I was wrong! Help me! I'm begging you! Please, forgive me!

STAFF MEMBER A
Take them away!

ANNA/CASH
Mom!

DORA
Ava…

AVA
Mom, it's okay. I could pay the $10 million back for him, but Cash has to face the consequences of his actions!

ERIC
That's right, Mom. If you bail him out now, he'll just do something worse next time.

Dora, defeated, nods reluctantly. Ava then turns to Eric.

AVA
Eric, I want to continue with the factory project. This place is too destitute. I want to open a school, a hospital, make this place better and better... I won't allow ignorance to fester here any further.

ERIC
Don't worry, my love. I understand.

AVA
Thank you, Eric!

ERIC
Why are you thanking me? I'm your husband! Besides, we've been married for three years, and now that you're back, I'm going to throw you the most spectacular wedding that the whole world has ever seen!

DORA
That's wonderful! Ava, being able to see you get married, I have no regrets in this life.
(to Eric)
Ava's suffered enough in her life. You'd better treat her well.

ERIC
Don't worry, Mom. I'm head over heels for her.

The group exchanges warm smiles.

EPISODE 60

88 INT. AVA'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - DAY 88

Black and white portraits of Mary and Carl sit on a wall-mounted table. Dora stands in front of the table, looking grief-stricken. Ava and Eric, dressed in black, stand behind Dora.

DORA
Your dad and Grandma were too old. They got too emotional, had a heart attack and stroke...
(chokes up)
Come, say something to them.

Ava steps forward, looking at the portraits. Eric stands beside her, supporting her.

AVA
Dad, Grandma, I'm doing well now. Mom, Eric and I live together and we're taking the best care of her. Please, rest in peace.

ERIC
Dad, Grandma, I'll stay by Ava's side and take good care of Mom too.
(to Ava)
You need to take care of yourself.
(MORE)

ERIC (CONT'D)
You're pregnant, so don't overexert yourself. We still have the school ribbon-cutting ceremony tomorrow.

Ava nods. Eric supports her as they move to the side. Dora looks at the portraits and can't help but cry.

DORA
Carl, Mom, why didn't you listen to me back then? Ava is such a good child. She helped with all your final arrangements.
(wipes tears)
Ava said she'll continue investing in our town. You can rest knowing the town will surely get better and better!

Dora turns and leaves. Ava and Eric support her as they walk out.

89 INT. CEREMONY HALL - DAY 89

Ava and Eric enter the hall. REPORTERS rush forward with microphones, and several students also crowd around them.

REPORTER
Ms. Ava, as the CEO of the Young Group, you now spend over tens of millions of dollars annually on scholarships. Because of you, Children who can't afford education can go to school. You're also building factories in your hometown. What motivates you to do such charitable work?

AVA
My vision is simple. I hope my hometown can return to its former glory, with everyone living and working in peace and contentment, and every child receiving the best education possible! Your destiny is in your own hands. Only by striving and moving forward can you create a life that truly belongs to you!

---THE END----